

Running the server as a container

The published image is `registry.badassium.com/fatalexception/yarg-song-server`, tagged `latest` and the commit short sha. It is a distroless static binary — **8.6 MB**, no shell, running as `nonroot`.

This document records the first real deployment, on vault2, 2026-09-05. **Start from the next section, not from that record** — the record is kept as history and following it today breaks the service.

Run it today — every argument read off the running container, 2026-11-01

> **Live build as of 2026-11-04: `c9edba5` on digest `sha256:17058211…`** — the eleventh deployment, immediately below. The arguments in this section are still the ones in use; the ninth and tenth deployments both reproduced them from `docker inspect` of the running container rather than from this document, and they matched both times.
>
> **The image TAG is 8 characters and `/version` reports 7.** The tag is `CI_COMMIT_SHORT_SHA` (`:5e9f255c`); `/version` comes from `git describe --always` (`5e9f255`). On 2026-11-04 a `docker manifest inspect` of the 7-character form answered *"no such manifest"* four hours after the pipeline had succeeded, which reads exactly like a build that never published. Pin by digest and take the tag from the registry, not from `/version`.

The `docker run` further down is the 2026-09-05 original and it no longer reproduces this service. Three of its arguments are now wrong, and two of them fail in ways that do not look like a deployment mistake:

Missing	What happens if you follow the old command
`-v /mnt/user/YARG/songs/unpacked:/songs/unpacked:rw`	`/songs` is mounted **read-only**, so this nested `rw` bind is the only thing that lets the server write unpacked output. Without it, unpacking fails against a read-only filesystem.
`--config /data/yarg-song-server.conf`	The config file is **not** loaded, so `unpack_ops` silently reverts to its default and the `admin_secret` is empty. The unpack API then answers **403** — which reads as the newly deployed build having broken it.

Missing	What happens if you follow the old command
`-v /mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/songs:/songs:ro`	Wrong path. The library moved to the array share `/mnt/user/YARG/songs`; the old path is an empty directory, so the server indexes **0 songs** and starts perfectly happily.

These arguments come from `docker inspect` of the container that was actually running, not from the previous version of this document. That provenance is the only thing that stops this rotting again: the doc had drifted twice before (the *Current state, measured 2026-09-15* section says so in its own first sentence), and on 2026-11-01 it had drifted a third time while being edited that same day in `2320f1d` without the drift being noticed.

```
# Pin the DIGEST. Never deploy a floating tag, and see the tag table below for
# why :latest in particular is not what it looks like.
IMAGE="registry.badassium.com/fatalexception/yarg-song-server@sha256:<digest>"

docker run -d --name yarg-song-server \
  --restart unless-stopped \
  -p 8099:8080 \
  -v /mnt/user/YARG/songs:/songs:ro \
  -v /mnt/user/YARG/songs/unpacked:/songs/unpacked:rw \
  -v /mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/data:/data \
  "$IMAGE" \
  --songs /songs --data /data --listen :8080 --config /data/yarg-song-server.conf
```

`USER` is `nonroot:nonroot` and `ENTRYPOINT` is `/usr/local/bin/yarg-song-server`, both from the image; neither needs stating on the command line. `Labels` is empty, which is the "not Unraid-managed" note further down, still true.

Eleventh deployment, 2026-11-04 — `c9edba5`, per-stem previews. DEPLOYED, invariants held

Live now: `c9edba5` on digest `sha256:17058211ceb2e7cf782821602a533d144cf00cb5d018824a15397ecc8eb43a19`, 4,085 songs, `problems` null. Previous container kept as `yarg-song-server-prev-5e9f255`; rollback is `docker rm -f yarg-song-server && docker rename yarg-song-server-prev-5e9f255 yarg-song-server && docker start yarg-song-server`.

```
DEPLOY    :c9edba53  sha256:17058211ceb2e7cf782821602a533d144cf00cb5d018824a15397ecc8eb43a19
ROLLBACK  :5e9f255c  sha256:bfc47bc816be304443b18e9bf5ff6cfeca64f9c08a5c67783f16e65f564d2fdb
```

Purely additive: 292 insertions, 0 deletions, one new route (`GET /song/{hash}/preview/{stem}`) and one new handler. No existing endpoint changed, which is why this one needed no byte-for-byte A/B of the old behaviour the way the tenth did.

The control was registered BEFORE the swap, and it is the whole verification

The old build must 404 on the new path, and the new build must not. Measured on the running `5e9f255` minutes before the swap:

```
old build /preview/song -> 404
```

Pre-registered	Observed	
hard-down ≈ 1 s	**0.948 s** — prev finished `13:26:48.786Z`, `listening` at `13:26:49.734Z`	✅
`/healthz` 503 `indexing`, `/version` 200 throughout	**503** then ready; **200** at every poll	✅
4,085 songs, 4,080 distinct, `problems` null	**4,085 / 4,080 / 0**, null	✅
index near the previous 507.9 s	**490.6 s** (`8m10.564s`), −3.4%	✅
`/preview/{stem}` 200 per stem, each its own bytes	**200** for song / guitar / drums_3 / vocals, four different sizes	✅
an unknown stem is 404, never a substitution	**404** `application/json`	✅
`ETag` differs per stem	three distinct tags, each naming its stem	✅
`preview.ogg` untouched	**200**, 7,272 bytes, same as before the swap	✅

```
song      -> 200  audio/ogg    7272 bytes
guitar    -> 200  audio/ogg  866874 bytes
drums_3   -> 200  audio/ogg  987552 bytes
vocals    -> 200  audio/ogg  798391 bytes
```

Those byte counts are identical to the throwaway probe's, which cut the same stems from a downloaded `.sng` with the same code on a different machine — two independent paths agreeing to the byte, which is a better check than either alone.

The client half, and why channel count is the only honest assertion

The fork (`ee32ee32`) builds a multi-channel mixer from these clips. Through BASS, via the production `LoadPreviewAudio`:

```
Metallica - ...And Justice for All   7 stems, own preview False  -> 7 channels, 32.18s, 754 ms
Fredrik Thordendal's - "Solo" Niger Within   1 stem             -> 1 channel,  30.06s, 452 ms
Motorhead - (We Are) The Road Crew   3 stems, ships preview     -> 1 channel,  30.07s, 122 ms
```

A mixer that merely decodes proves nothing here: the single-clip path also returns a perfectly good one-channel mixer and passes every assertion about length. The two one-channel rows are controls — without them, "channels > 1" would also be satisfied by a change that made every song mix, spending 5 MB on previews that need 713 KB.

Housekeeping

`yarg-song-server-prev-3a9bf3c` was removed during this swap, being two deployments old. The fallback chain is now one deep (`prev-5e9f255`), plus three older stopped containers that are somebody else's decision.

Tenth deployment, 2026-11-04 — `5e9f255`, MP3 previews. DEPLOYED, and the reason for it was wrong

Live now: `5e9f255` on digest `sha256:bfc47bc816be304443b18e9bf5ff6cfeca64f9c08a5c67783f16e65f564d2fdb`, 4,085 songs, `problems` null. Previous container kept as `yarg-song-server-prev-3a9bf3c`; rollback is `docker rm -f yarg-song-server && docker rename yarg-song-server-prev-3a9bf3c yarg-song-server && docker start yarg-song-server`.

```
DEPLOY    :5e9f255c  sha256:bfc47bc816be304443b18e9bf5ff6cfeca64f9c08a5c67783f16e65f564d2fdb
ROLLBACK  :3a9bf3c   sha256:4b07c333f58c4646d4aff3cfc7d43b1ebbc5b347cfd21d9010957f384146c1db
```

The deployment was justified by a claim that production disproves

The commit message says "*150 songs had no preview at all*". **They all had one.** Measured against the live `3a9bf3c` before the swap:

```
200  ct=audio/ogg  len=482304  magic=ff fb 94 64   Motorhead - (We Are) The Road Crew
200  ct=audio/ogg  len=398735  magic=ff fb 90 64   Queens of the Stone Age - 3's & 7's
200  ct=audio/ogg  len=338549  magic=ff fb 90 64   Foo Fighters - All My Life
```

Every one of the 150 ships a ready-made `preview.mp3`; `previewCandidates` puts a ready-made preview first and `ReadyMade` skips the extension filter, so the 415 that the whole change was built to remove never occurred. The premise came from a comment in that function reading "*Nothing in the live library does - 0 of 4,085*" — true when written, read as current. **215 of 4,085 ship their own preview today** (150 mp3, 63 ogg, 2 opus). The correction is in ADR-009 and the comment has been rewritten.

So this deployment delivers one header on 150 songs, and `CutMP3` runs on **zero** songs in this library. That last part was an assumption until it was counted after the swap, because there is a case where it would not hold: `stemPreference` prefers `song`, so a song carrying `song.mp3` *beside* a `guitar.ogg` would put the mp3 first, and `5e9f255` would cut it where `3a9bf3c` skipped past it to the ogg. That is the one shape in which this change alters bytes rather than a label. Measured:

```
stem files : 22,091 total, 449 of them .mp3
songs with >=1 mp3 stem       : 150
  of those, ALSO carrying ogg : 0
  of those, no ready-made prev: 0
```

All 449 mp3 stems live in those same 150 songs, every one of which has a ready-made preview that wins first. The cutter is correct and verified; it is insurance, not a fix.

The rehearsal was a full A/B, which is more than the method asked for

The eighth deployment's method fix was "run the artifact that will be deployed". Run on a spare port against the same `/songs` bind, the rehearsal is also the *old* build's live twin — so every invariant could be checked **before** the swap rather than after:

Checked on the rehearsal, before any production change	Result
4,085 songs, 4,080 distinct, 0 duplicate, `problems` null	identical to production
0 package hashes absent, 0 new, 0 chart hashes moved, 4,085 rows	**0 / 0 / 0**
`sort_attributes` identical	yes
`/healthz` 503 `indexing` + `Retry-After: 5`	yes
`POST /api/v1/have` 503 while indexing, never 200	yes
150 mp3 songs: `audio/ogg` → `audio/mpeg`	**150 of 150**
150 mp3 songs: clip bytes **byte-identical** (sha256 each)	**150 of 150**
60 ogg songs: still `audio/ogg`, byte-identical	**60 of 60**

That last pair is the one that could have failed — `cutExt` is assigned for a ready-made candidate too, so a wrong branch there would have changed the bytes and not just the label. It did not. **Nothing was left to be discovered after the swap**, which is what the A/B buys over a timing probe.

Pre-registered	Observed	
hard-down ≈ 1 s	**1.321 s** — prev finished `10:56:15.563Z`, `listening` at `10:56:16.884Z`	✅
`/version` 200 `5e9f255` throughout	**200** at every poll, 0 s–492 s	✅
`POST /api/v1/have` 503, never 200 while `/healthz` was 503	**503** at every poll	✅
4,085 songs, 4,080 distinct, `problems` null	**4,085 / 4,080 / 0**, null	✅
index within 10% of the rehearsal's 495.4 s (446–545 s)	**507.85 s** (`8m27.85s`), **+2.5%**	✅
0 chart hashes moved, 0 package hashes moved	**0 absent, 0 new, 0 moved** across 4,085 rows	✅
150 mp3 songs `audio/mpeg`, lengths unchanged	**150 / 150** both	✅
60 ogg controls still `audio/ogg`, lengths unchanged	**60 / 60** both	✅
`/song/{hash}.sng` 200, `ETag` = package hash; `Range` 206	**200**, ETag `8d4f9a30…` matches; **206**	✅

The rehearsal predicted the index to 2.5%, after predicting the ninth deployment's to 0%. Two runs is not a property of the method — the eighth deployment's local-cross-compile probe was 1.4% out once and 9.4% out the next time, which is exactly how a method looks accurate before it isn't. But both accurate runs share what the method fix asked for: the CI image, the real `/songs` bind, a spare port. Quote it as an estimate with a sign, not a measurement.

A finding on the live build that has nothing to do with MP3

Sampling 20 of the 3,870 songs that are actually **cut** (no ready-made preview), three clips came back at 4,407 / 7,225 / 8,623 bytes against a median of 814,901. I called them suspiciously small and suspected the cutter. Parsing the 7,272-byte one page by page says the cut is correct:

> `8 pages, one serial, EOS set on the last, last granule 1,419,298 = 32.18 s at 44.1 kHz`

Six audio pages of 537 bytes carrying 261,120 samples each — about 5.8 kbit/s. The clip is the right length and structurally valid; the **source stem is near-silent over that window**. These are RB-derived packages where `song.ogg` is a thin backing stem and the music lives in `guitar.ogg` / `drums_*.ogg`, while `stemPreference` prefers `song`. So ~15% of a 20-song sample previews something inaudible, the cutter is not at fault, and **stem selection is**. Not quantified across the library; recorded here so the next person does not re-suspect the cutter.

Ninth deployment, 2026-11-03 — `3a9bf3c`, preview clips. DEPLOYED, invariants held

Live now: `3a9bf3c` on digest `sha256:4b07c333…`, 4,085 songs, `problems` null. Previous container kept as `yarg-song-server-prev-01e0503`; rollback is `docker rm -f yarg-song-server && docker rename yarg-song-server-prev-01e0503 yarg-song-server && docker start yarg-song-server`.

Predictions were registered before the image was pulled, not after the swap.

Pre-registered	Observed	
hard-down ≈ 1 s	**1.200 s**	✅
`/healthz` 503 `indexing` + `Retry-After`	**503**, `Retry-After: 5`	✅
`POST /api/v1/have` 503, never 200	**503**	✅
`/version` 200 throughout	**200** `3a9bf3c`	✅
4,085 songs, `problems` null	**4,085**, 4,080 distinct charts, null	✅
0 chart hashes moved, 0 package hashes moved	**0 absent, 0 new, 0 moved** across 4,085 rows	✅
`/song/{hash}.sng` still 200, `ETag` = package hash	**200**, ETag `8d4f9a30…`; `Range` still **206**	✅
NEW: `/song/{hash}/preview.ogg` 200 `audio/ogg`, decodes	**200**, 942,048 bytes, 282 ms over the tailnet; VLC decoded **30.01 s** 44.1 kHz stereo, peak 0 dBFS, audible	✅
index ≈ 638 s	**431 s**	❌

The size prediction said "≈545 KB" from a local test on a different song; the live figure is 942,048 bytes because the first catalogue song is a Marathon Hero chart whose `preview_start_ms` is **684,770** — eleven minutes in. That exercised the skip-ahead path far harder than anything local did, which is a better test than the one that was predicted.

`/song/{hash}.sng` is listed because `songFile` was edited in this change — its chart-hash resolution moved into a shared `resolveChart` so the two endpoints cannot drift into different answers for the same library. It was the prediction most likely to be wrong and it held.

The miss is the eighth deployment's baseline, not this build — and the rehearsal called it exactly

```
eighth deployment, measured     638.744 s
this deployment, predicted      ~638 s      (from that figure)
rehearsal container, measured   431 s
production, measured            431 s       prediction -32%, REHEARSAL 0%
```

The rehearsal predicted production to the second, at the 10-second polling granularity used for both. That is the method fix from the eighth deployment working as intended: that deployment's probe was a local cross-compile and came in 9.4% optimistic, and the recorded conclusion was that a probe must run **the artifact that will be deployed**. Run that way — the CI image, the real `/songs` bind, a spare port — the error went to zero.

So the ❌ is against a stale baseline rather than against this build. **Why 638 s became 431 s is not established.** A warm page cache on `/mnt/user/YARG/songs` after the rehearsal had just walked it is the obvious candidate and would be a mechanism, not a measurement; the rehearsal ran first and would have warmed exactly that. Recorded as unexplained rather than attributed, because the eighth deployment's own lesson was that a plausible mechanism is not a cause.

Do not carry 638 s forward as the baseline. Two runs tonight on the same box and library both said 431 s.

What this deployment does not establish

- **The clip has never met BASS.** VLC decoded it and Jay listened to one; the game's own decoder is still untested, and ADR-009's standard is the real client. The client side is unwritten, so nothing in YARG requests a preview yet.
- **No disk cache.** Every request the `ETag` does not satisfy cuts the clip again — 282 ms over the tailnet here, and ADR-009 records it as a gap.
- **MP3 and WAV are not cut**: 449 of 22,091 stem files answer 415.

Eighth deployment, 2026-11-02 — `6cbea44`, hash-once. DEPLOYED, invariants held

Live now: `6cbea44` on digest `sha256:7bda5f29…`, 4,085 songs, `problems` null.

Pre-registered	Observed	
hard-down ≈ 1 s	**0.977 s** — prev finished `12:27:46.736Z`, new started `12:27:47.712Z`, `listening` at `12:27:48.141Z`	✅
`/healthz` 503 `indexing` + `Retry-After`	**503,** `indexing`**,** `Retry-After: 5`	✅
`POST /api/v1/have` 503, never 200	**503** throughout; never 200 while indexing	✅
`/version` 200 throughout	**200** `6cbea44` at every poll, 0 s–621 s	✅

Pre-registered	Observed	
`package_hash` **: 0 of 4,085 moved**	**0**	✅
`chart_hash` : 0 of 4,085 moved	**0**	✅
issue codes unchanged	`chart_truncated: 2` , `metadata_unreachable: 1` — and **0** songs with a changed issue set	✅
the `album.PNG` song, checked by name	`15465de7…` **unchanged**	✅
index ≈ **9m38s**	**10m38.744s**	❌

Also 0 songs absent and 0 newly present, so the before/after compared the same 4,085 songs rather than a shifted set — the gap the stability check existed to protect.

The one miss: the probe was 9.4% OPTIMISTIC, and its accuracy is not a property of the method

```
baseline 473aee0   937.632s
probe predicted    578.478s      implied 1.621x
production actual  638.744s      real    1.468x     probe -9.4%
```

The throwaway-instance method predicted the `473aee0` deploy to **within 14 seconds (1.4%)**, and this one to within **60 seconds (9.4%)** — and in the optimistic direction both in the ratio and in the absolute. So the earlier 1.4% was not a property of the method; its error varied by a factor of seven between two runs on the same box and the same library.

It is still the right tool — it costs no downtime and it was the only way to know the sign and rough size of the win beforehand — but **a probe figure is an estimate, not a measurement of the thing that will happen.** Quote it as a floor, with the caveat below attached.

Why, and it is sharper than "probes are fuzzy": the probe measured a DIFFERENT BINARY. Not a different *source* — identical commit — but a different build. The probe was a local cross-compile on ENG-1's Go 1.27.0 with `-trimpath` and custom `-ldflags` (which is why it reported `dev`); production runs CI's container build with CI's own pinned toolchain. So the 9.4% never isolated hash-once at all: it conflates it with *this workstation's Go versus the runner's Go* — different compiler version, different flags, possibly different inlining and GC tuning. A 9% spread between two Go builds of identical source is ordinary.

Two candidates killed by measurement rather than left as "unlikely":

- **cgroup limits: dead.** The container has none — `NanoCpus` 0, `CpuShares` 0, `CpusetCpus` empty, `CpuPeriod` / `CpuQuota` 0, `Memory` 0 — on a 12-CPU, 62.7 GB host with no cpuset, so `GOMAXPROCS` was 12 in both runs.
- **mount shape and `--data` location: real but implausibly small.** `/songs` is a bind with `/songs/unpacked` a second bind *nested inside it*, where the probe read the unpacked path directly; crossing a mountpoint is near-free per lookup, so 27,541 files should not buy 60 seconds. And `/tmp` on that box is tmpfs, so the probe's `--data` lived in RAM against production's btrfs — but the pack cache is tens of files under a 2 GiB bound, far too few to matter.

THE METHOD FIX, and it is the useful output of the miss: a throwaway probe must run THE ARTIFACT THAT WILL BE DEPLOYED. Pull the CI image and run it as a throwaway *container* on a spare port with the same binds — not a locally cross-compiled binary. That removes the build variable entirely and makes the probe a dress rehearsal instead of an approximation. It would also have surfaced the readiness-signal change by itself, rather than needing a warning.

The build difference is a hypothesis with a mechanism, not a measurement, and is not recorded as the established cause.

Following that method fix, 2026-11-03: two walls, neither of which looks like its cause

The ninth deployment ran the rehearsal as prescribed — the CI image, the real `/songs` bind, its own `/data`, a spare port, live service untouched — and hit two things worth knowing first.

The container exits 1 with `packcache: mkdir /data/packs: permission denied`. The image runs as `nonroot:nonroot`, so a `--data` directory created by `root` (which is what `mkdir /tmp/...` over SSH gives you) is not writable by the process. It reads as a broken build or a bad image. `chmod 777` the throwaway directory; the live `/data` under appdata is already owned correctly, which is exactly why this never bites the real deployment.

Pick the port by looking, not by assuming. On this box `8090`, `8092`, `8093`, `8098` and `8099` were all listening. A conflict leaves the container in `Created` with **no logs at all** and a stray `docker-proxy` holding the port, which looks like a container that failed to start for its own reasons:

```
ss -ltn | awk '{print $4}' | grep -oE ':809[0-9]$' | sort -u
```

And run the `docker run` so its stderr is visible. Wrapping it in a pipeline under `set -e` swallowed the message both times, which is how a plain permission error cost two round trips.

The real win on this library is therefore 1.468×, which is also a floor: the baseline ran essentially alone while this run followed a probe.

Housekeeping noted, not acted on

Six containers now exist for this image, five of them stopped — back to `yarg-song-server-prev` from seven weeks ago on `:027d331f`. The two most recent are deliberate fallbacks; the older ones are clutter on somebody's decision, not mine to remove.

What was pre-registered, before the swap

Written before the swap so the result is read against a record. Baseline snapshot taken from the live server minutes earlier: `built_at 01:09:32.181Z`, 4,085 songs, 4,080 distinct, 0 duplicate, `problems` null, every `package_hash` and issue code captured.

```
DEPLOY    :6cbea444  sha256:7bda5f2968680e66ee8178c74c5698ffa85428b869065cdfad917074769bdf99
ROLLBACK  :473aee0d  sha256:241fc7ee72ea44eb81cd19aab40757792652d2f79e899bac5cf7c67f20130daa
```

Both pinned now rather than re-resolved mid-incident. Control tag answered on the same poll as the deploy tag, so PRESENT means *built*, not *authorised*.

Why this before/after is weaker than the probe, and what closes the gap. The probe compared two binaries on the same files *at one moment*. This compares one binary before against another ~10 minutes after, so **any** library change in the window would be attributed to hash-once. Checked seconds before: **0** `*.unpacking` directories anywhere, **0** entries under `_incoming`, one container box-wide by image. *(The `/api/v1/unpack` probe returned "admin secret is missing or wrong" — an auth failure, not an answer, so it establishes nothing and the directory checks are what carry it.)*

Expected	Why
hard-down ≈ **1 s**, not ~17 min	`473aee0` already has the gate, so the replaced binary binds nothing and the new one binds at once
index ≈ **9m38s**, not 15m37s	hash-once measured at 1.62× on this array
`/healthz` 503 `indexing` → 200 `ok`	the gate, in production again
`POST /api/v1/have` 503, never 200	the data-loss invariant
`package_hash` : 0 of 4,085 moved	the whole claim — this hash is the `ETag` and the sync identity
`chart_hash` : 0 of 4,085 moved	identity is `SHA1(chart bytes)` and nothing here touches chart reading
issue codes unchanged: `chart_truncated: 2`, `metadata_unreachable: 1`	catches the scanner deciding something *different* about identical bytes, which hashing alone cannot show

If exactly one `package_hash` moves, look here first: `unpacked/Guitar Hero III DLC/Guitar Hero III DLC/Boston - Peace of Mind`, whose `album.PNG` is the single asset name in 26,575 that `strings.ToLower` changes. Pre-registering it turns the most confusing possible result into a lookup.

ROLLBACK TRIGGER, decided now and not in the moment: ANY `package_hash` moving → roll back to `473aee0d` immediately, investigate afterwards. A moved `ETag` is every client re-downloading that song; it is not a thing to debug while live.

And one thing not to misread: during the index, any sync client that runs gets 503 from `/api/v1/have` and aborts. That is the gate working as designed. Last night the same window was invisible only because the server was not answering at all.

Seventh deployment, 2026-11-02 — `473aee0`, and the outage that did not happen

DEPLOYED and verified. Live now: `473aee0` on digest `sha256:241fc7ee…`, 4,085 songs, `problems` null.

> **The predicted cost was wrong by three orders of magnitude, and this deploy is what disproved it.** Every version of this document, and the ADR, said the deploy shipping the fix would itself be hard-down for ~17 minutes "because the binary being replaced is the one without the fix". **Measured hard-down: 0.77 seconds.** The previous container finished `01:09:31.100Z`, the new one started `01:09:31.868Z`, and the first poll at t=0 already answered `503 indexing`.
>
> The reasoning was broken, not merely imprecise: **the binary that decides whether the port is open during start-up is the one STARTING**, not the one being replaced. The new binary has the fix, so it binds at once; the old one's lack of it stops mattering the moment it stops. Both of us reasoned about which binary *lacked* the fix instead of asking which binary *opens the port*, and neither asked the question at all — it was assumed symmetrical, and it is not.
>
> The server's own log is the cleaner proof, better than the container timestamps:
>
> `01:09:31.100Z old container finished 01:09:31.868Z new container started -> 0.768s 01:09:32.181Z listening addr=:8080 version=473aee0 01:25:09.822Z library indexed songs=4085 took=15m37.632s`
>
> **The listener bound 15m37s before the index finished**, serving 503s for all of it. That single pair of lines is the change working in production and the refutation of what was predicted, in the same four lines.
>
> **The error inverts, which is the operationally important half: the ROLLBACK is now the expensive direction.** `fab8c90c` has no readiness gate, so rolling onto it costs a full hard-down index — about sixteen minutes at this library size. Reaching for a rollback under pressure now costs vastly more than the deploy did.

What it did, against the checks written before it ran:

Pre-registered	Observed
hard-down during the swap	**0.77 s** (predicted ~17 min)
`/healthz` 503, body `indexing`, `Retry-After`	**503,** `indexing`, `Retry-After: 5`
`POST /api/v1/have` 503 throughout	**503**, `{"error":"the song library is still being indexed; ask again shortly"}`
`/have` ever 200 while indexing	**no** — the data-loss payload never appeared
`/version` 200 throughout the index	**200** `473aee0` at every poll, 0 s to 922 s
after the index: 200 `ok`, 4,085 songs, `problems` null	**all three**, healthy at 942 s

The index itself took 942 s against 1008 s for the same 4,085 songs on `0c6fa84` — not a controlled comparison, and not claimed as one.

And the bare-CR witness still holds on the new binary: exactly **1** song carrying `metadata_unreachable` naming `playlist_track = 4`, `song_length` intact at `1062206`, `playlist_track` absent from `raw_metadata`, and `GET /song/b67974e3….sng` → 200, 38,972,988 bytes, `SNGPKG`, `ETag == package_hash`. Control characters across all 4,085

songs: **0**, which is the fix working rather than missing.

Two honest footnotes. `POST /api/v1/have` is **200** after the index — the deploy script reported 400 for it, which was that script's own quoting (JSON through a nested `$()` inside a double-quoted string), not the server; re-asked with the body in a file it answers 200 with `library_total 4080`. And issue codes across the catalogue are now `chart_truncated: 2` and `metadata_unreachable: 1` — the second `chart_truncated` is new since the 3,067-song index and arrived with the 1,018 newly unpacked songs.

Chased down rather than left as "unrelated": it is truncated inside the source zip, and the extraction is faithful. It is *Beenox Logo* by François Jalbert in *Guitar Hero – Smash Hits* — the CP437-named folder, which is why it was checked carefully instead of assumed. Every file matches the archive byte for byte, five sizes rather than one, because a single match could be luck:

```
              in archive   on disk
album.png        492,537    492,537
desktop.ini          136        136
guitar.ogg       538,987    538,987
notes.mid         53,336     53,336
song.ini           1,129      1,129
```

So the chart is corrupt in the pack as shipped, and nothing in this project broke it. Note what it is, too: a studio logo stinger of a couple of seconds, not a song anyone plays. **The useful reading is that the scanner did its job** — it flagged a genuinely corrupt chart that YARG would refuse, which is the standard `CLAUDE.md` sets. Nothing to fix in our code. The other `chart_truncated`, *All Nightmare Long* in Guitar Hero III DLC, predates all of this.

What was prepared in advance

Everything below was checked before the deploy so that none of it happened under time pressure.

```
image     registry.badassium.com/fatalexception/yarg-song-server:473aee0d
digest    sha256:241fc7ee72ea44eb81cd19aab40757792652d2f79e899bac5cf7c67f20130daa
          multi-arch amd64 + arm64,  --version reports 473aee0
rollback  fab8c90c
digest    sha256:08e3df8c2d143fa608ed4287ff48cceb8fabc7ce4a24f5e35e77b098b8964139
```

Pre-swap check	Result
tag PRESENT **and** control tag `ok` on the same poll	built, not merely authorised
`git diff 0c6fa84..473aee0 -- internal/config/`	**empty** — verified locally
valid-key list, both builds	**identical**, 12 keys — verified locally
`--version` asked of the image, not predicted	`473aee0`
rollback target contains the `.rar` fix	`grep -c storedName` = 3

The config check is a *proof* rather than a comparison of dates: the live `/data/yarg-song-server.conf` is accepted by `0c6fa84` — it is running on it now — and `473aee0` accepts exactly the same key set, so it must accept that file too. The dangerous direction (an *older* binary meeting a newer config, which `internal/config` turns into a refusal to boot)

does not arise.

A health loop must match the **short sha** `473aee0`. Anything asserting a release-shaped `v0.1.x` string would tear down a correctly deployed server — this document has already been wrong about that once.

The one part no rollback undoes *(written before the deploy, and WRONG — see the correction at the top of this section)*: the deploy was expected to cost one more hard-down window of roughly seventeen minutes, on the reasoning that the binary being replaced is the one without the fix. It cost **0.77 seconds**. What it does buy is real: the 4,085-song index stops being an availability cliff that grows with the library.

What to verify afterwards — written BEFORE the deploy

"It came back up" is not the claim this change makes, and a deploy that only proves liveness proves the wrong thing. **A red-proofed test shows the test catches the defect; only the deploy shows the SERVER does.** Those are different claims and just the second one is about production, so the checks are recorded here first, against which the result can be read rather than interpreted.

During the ~17-minute window, expect	Why it matters
TCP connect **refused**, not 503	the old binary is still the one without the fix; this is the last time it should look like this
after the swap, `/healthz` → **503**, body `indexing`, `Retry-After` set	the whole availability half
`POST /api/v1/have` → **503**, and *never* 200 with an empty list	the data-loss invariant, observed in production rather than in a test
`/version` → 200 `473aee0` throughout the index	the operator can ask what is running while it cannot serve
after the index, `/healthz` → 200 `ok`, songs = 4,085, `problems` null	the ordinary end state

Falsification, stated too: `/healthz` answering **200 while the index is still running** means the readiness gate is not wired in the deployed binary, and the visible outage has become an invisible one — roll back on that alone, even though the server would look healthy.

Keep `0c6fa84`'s container even though it is not the rollback target. It is the fastest way back to a known-serving state if `fab8c90c` surprises you, and surrendering `.rar` ingest for twenty minutes beats being down.

Pin the **digest**, never the tag: a tag can be rebuilt and repointed, and this document already carries the two-builds-of-one-commit case.

The git tags have drifted from the image tags — so a version string cannot identify a build

`git describe --tags --always --dirty` is what CI stamps into the binary (`--build-arg VERSION=...`). The newest *annotated git tag* is still `v0.1.2`, while the *image* tags have run ahead through `v0.1.3-yargsong`, `v0.1.4-multisong`, `v0.1.5-unpack`, `v0.1.7-reserved`, `v0.1.8-unpack`, `v0.1.9-sets` and `v0.2.0-nested` — all built on the box, none of them a git tag.

> **And the same commit stamps DIFFERENTLY in CI than it does on a workstation.** This section first claimed commit `0c6fa84` would report `v0.1.2-37-g0c6fa84`, because that is what `git describe` prints on ENG-1. The deployed image reports `0c6fa84` — measured from the running container, which is what corrected it. CI's clone has **no tags fetched**, so `git describe --tags` finds none and `--always` falls through to the abbreviated commit hash, seven characters. A workstation clone has the tags and so takes the `v0.1.2-37-g…` branch instead.
>
> So the version string depends on the clone that built it, which makes it even less usable as an identity than the tag drift above already implied. **Ask the image, never predict it** — the `--version` call below is the only answer that is about the artifact rather than about where it was built.

Two consequences worth having in front of you:

- **No image since `v0.1.2` can be identified from `/version` alone.** A running server reporting `v0.1.8-unpack` and one reporting `v0.1.2-37-g0c6fa84` tell you nothing comparable; the first is a hand-set string, the second is a commit.
- **A health check must match on the COMMIT, not on a release-shaped string.** A loop asserting `/version` contains `v0.2.` would fail against a correctly deployed CI build and roll it back — a check that rejects a good deploy is worse than no check. Match the short sha. This is not hypothetical. The 2026-11-01 deploy's health loop matched on `0c6fa84` and passed; the full string this document had predicted, `v0.1.2-37-g0c6fa84`, is **not** what the image reports, so a loop asserting it would have torn down a healthy server and restored the previous one. The check survived its author being wrong about the value, which is the only reason it was a check and not a coin flip.

And because a digest identifies a **build** rather than a commit, verify the binary's own idea of what it is *before* swapping, while nothing is stopped yet:

```
docker run --rm --entrypoint /usr/local/bin/yarg-song-server "$IMAGE" --version
```

The drift, finally seen from both sides of ONE commit — 2026-11-01

Earlier this document *predicted* a version string wrongly and was corrected afterwards. It has now been observed directly, both halves at once, for the same commit `fab8c90`:

Build of `fab8c90`	Reports
cross-compiled on a workstation clone	`v0.1.2-40-gfab8c90`
the CI image of the same source	`fab8c90`

CI's clone fetches no tags, so `git describe --tags --always` finds none and falls through to the abbreviated hash; a workstation clone has the tags and takes the other branch. **Same source, two strings.** So a health check must match on the short SHA and never on the whole string — which this document already said, and which is now measured rather than inferred.

`denied` from the registry is indistinguishable from `not built`

`docker manifest inspect` answered `denied: access forbidden` for a tag CI had in fact built, which reads exactly like "the pipeline never published it" — and that was nearly written down as a finding about CI.

What settled it was asking for a **control tag that certainly exists**: the tag the live container was *running at that moment*. It returned the same `denied`. One query that must succeed, failing the same way, proved the answer was about authentication and said nothing whatever about the subject. After the login both resolved.

Keep the control in the procedure rather than in someone's memory: **before concluding anything from a registry refusal, ask it for a tag you know is there.** This is the house rule — check the instrument before the subject — and on this one night it paid out twice, here and on the `splitext` song-folder count in ADR-008.

Amendment, measured later the same night: once authenticated, the registry's "no" becomes truthful, and the two cases separate. Asked for three tags with the login in place:

```
0c6fa842   PRESENT            <- the control: the tag the live container runs
fab8c90c   PRESENT
473aee0d   NO: no such manifest
```

An *unbuilt* tag now says `no such manifest` — a different answer from `denied: access forbidden`, and an honest one.

Measured vs inferred, because this was first written down here as though it were all one thing: the two **wordings** in the two **auth states** were observed. That the authentication is what *causes* the difference is a reading consistent with them, not a controlled test — nobody re-broke the login to confirm the old wording comes back. So treat "authenticated, the registry's no is legible" as the working explanation and not as established.

Which is exactly why **the control tag stays in the loop regardless**: it costs one query, and it makes the distinction unnecessary to reason about.

Put the control tag in any WATCHER, not just in a one-off check. A poll that asks only about the tag it is waiting for cannot tell "not built yet" from "the login lapsed", and it will report the first while meaning the second for as long as nobody looks. Asking for a known-present tag in the same poll turns that into an explicit `LOGIN_LAPSED`.

Counting this server's containers: NAME misses some, IMAGE misses others

Both halves of this were learned the hard way on 2026-11-02, in opposite directions, and each fix created the other's blind spot. **The correct sweep is the UNION of name and image.**

Filter	Misses	How it was found
`--filter name=yarg-song-server`	anything started **without** `--name`	a container docker had auto-named `gallant_ardinghelli` ran for **15 hours** while both sessions believed nothing was running. It was the first `unpack sets` call on a stale `:latest` that predated the subcommand, so the arguments were swallowed and the old binary started as a *server*. Measured before being touched: 0 CPU over 14h42m, 123 MB read total all at 21:41Z, so it contaminated none of the timings

Filter	Misses	How it was found
`--format '{{.Image}}' | grep <registry path>`	anything on a **locally-tagged** build	a cleanup sweep filtered on the registry image and reported itself finished, leaving four containers on `v0.1.3-yargsong`, `v0.1.4-multisong` and `v0.1.8-unpack` invisible to it

A name filter also matches **too much**: see the buildkit note below, where `name=yarg-song-server` caught `buildx_buildkit_yarg-song-server-multiarch0` mid-pipeline.

So a container census is three questions, not one: match on name, match on image *however tagged*, and check the start time and image of anything that comes back before concluding what it is.

`docker ps --filter name=yarg-song-server` also matches the CI builder

The filter is a **substring** match, and the multi-arch job must create a `docker-container` buildx builder (the default driver cannot emit a manifest list at all — see `CLAUDE.md`). So mid-pipeline the box legitimately shows:

```
yarg-song-server                              <- the server
buildx_buildkit_yarg-song-server-multiarch0   moby/buildkit:buildx-stable-1
```

A second container called `…yarg-song-server…`, "Up 17 seconds", on a box where nobody is deploying, reads **exactly** like an unannounced deploy. It is the pipeline. Check the image and the start time before concluding anything: the server's image is the digest pinned above, a builder's is `moby/buildkit`.

(Not independently verified here — measured on the box by the session holding the login, and recorded as theirs.)

The image the next deploy builds on

```
registry.badassium.com/fatalexception/yarg-song-server:fab8c90c
sha256:08e3df8c2d143fa608ed4287ff48cceb8fabc7ce4a24f5e35e77b098b8964139
multi-arch amd64 + arm64,  --version reports fab8c90
```

Cleared as a safe swap by the check in the next section rather than by assumption: `git diff 0c6fa84..fab8c90 -- internal/config/` is **empty**, so no config key was added and this image cannot refuse the live `/data/yarg-song-server.conf`. The only Go change in that range is `internal/scan/extract.go` and its tests.

The instinctive rollback target is THE BUILD CURRENTLY RUNNING, and it is the wrong one. Under pressure the version you reach for is the one you just came from — here `0c6fa84`, which is live and which **predates the `.rar` directory-flag fix**: a song folder inside a `.rar` read as a zero-byte file, which is why Marathon Hero 2 failed to unpack twice. The *stopped* container (`v0.1.8-unpack`) is older still. So both obvious fallbacks silently give up `.rar` ingest, and nothing notices until the next archive arrives.

Roll back to `fab8c90c`, pinned by the digest recorded above.

> **AND KNOW WHAT IT COSTS, because this reversed on 2026-11-02.** `fab8c90c` has **no readiness gate**: rolling onto it means a full hard-down index, about **sixteen minutes** at 4,085 songs, with the port closed throughout. Going *forward* to `473aee0` cost **0.77 seconds**. The cheap direction is forward and the expensive direction is back — the reverse of what every note in this document said before that deploy. A rollback is reached for under pressure by someone who has not read this file, so: rolling back is now the outage.

Ask each candidate whether it CONTAINS the fix, rather than which commit came first — ancestry answers a question about the graph, a rollback cares about the behaviour of the thing you land on:

```
git show <candidate>:internal/scan/extract.go | grep -c storedName
```

```
0c6fa84   0   -> .rar unpack BROKEN     (live; the instinctive target)
fab8c90   3   -> .rar dirs fixed        <- roll back here
473aee0   3   -> .rar dirs fixed
```

One command, and it answers what the ancestry check only implies.

Two things on that box that belong to NEITHER session, so neither removed them

Recorded because an unexplained file is how a future session talks itself into deleting something load-bearing.

- `/tmp/yss-arm64.tar` — dated 2026-09-06 12:15, two months before any of the 2026-11-01/02 work, root-owned 0600, a POSIX tar. Almost certainly left by `ci/verify-multiarch.sh`, which reads the ELF machine type out of the arm64 image. Both sessions looked at it, neither put it there, neither touched it.
- `/mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/probe-data` — an empty directory from an index probe that would not `rmdir`. Harmless: it is in appdata, not under `--songs`, so no library walk ever sees it. Left rather than forced.

And what was deliberately KEPT rather than cleaned: `/mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/unpack-logs/*`, the unpack, index-probe and restart records with their measured timings. That is evidence, not scratch — most of the numbers in this document's 2026-11-02 sections came out of it.

Scratch that WAS removed, for the record: the probe binaries from both sessions (`/tmp/yss-6cbea44`, `/mnt/user/YARG/bin/yss-fab8c90` and the `bin/` directory made for it), their data dirs and logs, and the batch scripts. An unsigned 9 MB executable on a world-readable SMB share is not a thing to leave behind once the registry carries the same build.

Registry credentials live only in docker's own store on the box (`/root/.docker/config.json`, mode 600, root-owned) — the route the *Registry authentication* section below already sanctions. Do not copy one anywhere else, and if one ever has to be reported, report its length and a sha256 prefix, never the value.

After ADR-008 ships, `/healthz` means something new

The serve-while-indexing change is implemented but **not yet deployed**. Once it is, the health gate's observations change and a deployer should know which is which:

During start-up	Before ADR-008	After
TCP connect	**refused**	accepted
`/healthz`	nothing to ask	**503**, body `indexing`, with `Retry-After`
`/api/v1/have`	nothing to ask	**503** — never `200`, which is the invariant
`/version`	nothing to ask	`200` — askable throughout

A gate that waits for `/healthz` to return **200** keeps working unchanged and is still correct: 503 means wait. A gate that merely waits for the port to open would pass on a server that cannot serve a song, so do not weaken it to that.

The deploy that ships this is itself still hard-down, because the binary being replaced is the one without the fix. Every restart after it is soft. There is no restart at which this gets cheaper to adopt.

Check the config file against the binary before you swap

`internal/config` treats an **unrecognised key as a startup error**, not a warning. So a config written for a newer build will stop an older one from booting at all, and that is an outage rather than a failed health check. Before deploying a build older than the config file, boot it against a copy of that key set — reading the valid-key list does not settle it.

What this deployment proved, that nothing had proved before

The multi-arch CI job verifies the image config's architecture and the ELF machine type of the binary inside. Both are checks on *bytes*. Until this deployment **the published image had never actually been run** — not by CI, not by anyone. It now has:

```
library indexed songs=22 distinct_charts=22 duplicate_packages=0 problems=0 took=7ms
listening addr=:8080 songs=/songs data=/data version=827e0fe
```

`version=827e0fe` is how you know the image is the commit it claims to be.

It also moved the server off the development machine for the first time. Every earlier measurement was `127.0.0.1`, which cannot fail in any of the ways a real network can.

The deployment

> **HISTORY, NOT INSTRUCTIONS.** This is the 2026-09-05 command, correct for the day it was written. Running it today gives a server that indexes 0 songs, cannot write unpacked output, and answers 403 from the unpack API. Use *Run it today* above.

```
# on the host
mkdir -p /mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/songs \
         /mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/data
chown -R 65532:65532 /mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/data

docker run -d --name yarg-song-server \
  --restart unless-stopped \
  -p 8099:8080 \
  -v /mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/songs:/songs:ro \
  -v /mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/data:/data \
  registry.badassium.com/fatalexception/yarg-song-server:latest
```

> `:latest` **CHANGED MEANING ON 2026-09-08, and everything written below this line predates that.** It used to follow the default branch, so `:latest` was "the newest commit on main" and the deployment records further down confirm it that way — correctly, for the day they were written. It now means **the newest release tag**. The tags are:
>
> | Tag | Means |
> |---|---|
> | `:<short sha>` | that exact build, eight characters, never moves — **this is what a deployment pins** |
> | `:main` | the default branch head; the honest replacement for what `:latest` used to be |
> | `:vX.Y.Z` | a release, built from that tag's own commit |
> | `:latest` | the newest **release**, which is deliberately older than main most of the time |
>
> The `docker run` above uses `:latest` only to get a first container onto the box. **Pin the eight-character sha for anything you intend to keep**, exactly as the rest of this document does.
>
> **A digest identifies a BUILD, not a commit.** Commit `6c686ce` was built twice on 2026-09-08 — once from `ci/tag-images`, once from `main` — with an identical version string (`v0.1.0-5-g6c686ce`) and identical source, and the two images have different digests (`e982e528…` and `ee21f46f…`). Container images are not bit-reproducible here the way the release archives are: the image config carries build timestamps and nothing sets `SOURCE_DATE_EPOCH` . So the digest comparison used further down proves "this tag and that tag are the same image", which is what it was used for — it does **not** prove "this image is the only one that commit can produce". The `:<sha>` tag resolves to whichever build of that commit pushed last.
>
> That is not hypothetical — it is true in the registry right now. Commit `1ef7598e` was built by its `main` pipeline at 16:56 and again by the `v0.1.1` tag pipeline at 17:06, so today:
>
> `:1ef7598e a127c732… the tag build, pushed second :v0.1.1 a127c732… same image :latest a127c732… same image :main 9b1d0f03… the earlier build of THE SAME COMMIT`
>
> `:main` and `:1ef7598e` disagree while naming one commit. Neither is wrong.

Three things there are not decoration:

- **`chown 65532`.** The image is distroless and runs as `nonroot`, uid 65532. `/data` holds the on-demand pack cache and must be writable by that uid or the server starts fine and then fails the first time somebody asks for a song that is stored as anything but a `.sng` — a loose folder, a `.zip` or a `.7z`, all of which are packed on demand. `/songs` stays root-owned and is mounted `:ro`, because the server never writes to the library and should not be able to.
- **`/mnt/cache/...`, not `/mnt/user/...`.** An absolute pool path, not the shfs union. This host has a documented history of SQLite-on-FUSE corruption, and `/mnt/user` was **99% full** at deployment (568 GB of 29 TB) while the cache pool had 1.4 TB free.
- **`-p 8099:8080`.** 8099 was free; the container listens on 8080 internally. Checked against `ss -ltn` rather than assumed — this host had 59 containers running and 76 ports already in LISTEN.

Registry authentication

The host's stored credential was stale and `docker pull` failed with `unauthorized: HTTP Basic: Access denied`. A GitLab personal access token with the `api` scope works for a registry pull — measured; `read_registry` is the documented scope but was not required here.

Log in without putting the secret in `argv`, where `ps` would show it:

```
docker login registry.badassium.com -u <user> --password-stdin <<'ENDTOK'
<token>
ENDTOK
```

The token comes from 1Password at run time and is never written to a file, a commit, or this document.

End-to-end result, 2026-09-05

Step	Result
Pull and start on vault2	running, 0 restarts, indexed 22 songs in 7 ms
`GET /healthz` from the host	200
`yarg-sync` from ENG-1 over Tailscale	22 downloaded, 0 failed, 229,515 bytes in **341 ms**
Byte count vs the localhost run	**identical** — same archives, different machine
Second sync	0 downloaded, 22 already present, **0 bytes**, 19 ms
Unmodified YARG on the synced folder	**20 accepted, 2 refused**

The two refusals were the same two, for the same reasons, as every earlier run — `no notes found` and `no audio accompanying the chart file`, both independently flagged by our own scanner.

The client reached the server by its **Tailscale name**, not a LAN literal, so the same command works from anywhere ENG-1 happens to be. A `192.168.2.x` address would have worked at the time of the test and failed from the office.

The pack cache bound, verified here rather than in a test

`pack_cache_max` shipped with six red-proofed tests and did not work. Every test inserted, so every test reached eviction through the insert path; this deployment's cache was already full, every request was a hit, nothing was ever packed, and the bound was never enforced. Deploying it found that in under a minute.

After the fix (`6bcf4ec` , enforce at start as well as on insert), running deliberately tight at **102,400 bytes** against a library that packs to 229,515:

Moment	Cache
Before restart, from the broken build	229,515 bytes, 22 archives
Immediately after start, having served nothing	**67,681 bytes, 6 archives**
After serving all 22 songs	67,681 bytes, 6 archives
Songs the client received	**22 of 22, 0 failed**

Three things in that table, in order of importance:

- The cache dropped from 22 archives to 6 **before a single request arrived**. That is the start-up enforcement, and it is the case the tests all missed.
- It stayed at 6 while serving 22 songs, so eviction kept pace with insertion rather than merely happening once.
- **Every song was still delivered and verified.** Sixteen of the twenty-two had to be re-packed mid-sync because eviction had removed them, and the client — which re-derives each song's identity from the bytes it receives — accepted all of them. That is the concrete evidence that eviction costs a re-pack and never data.

> **The conclusion drawn from that third bullet was too strong, and the number in it was a clue nobody read.** "Eviction costs a re-pack and never data" is true; "and therefore the re-packed archive is the same archive" does not follow, and was false. Those same sixteen songs came back with *different bytes* — the packer drew a random mask per call — which the client could not notice, because it verifies the chart's identity and the chart is copied byte for byte. Identity survived; the archive did not. The next day the same sixteen turned up as sixteen SHA-256 mismatches between two machines, and that is what named the defect. Fixed on 2026-09-06 by deriving the mask; `docs/TEST-CORPUS.md` has the run. **A client that verifies identity will accept a byte stream that a cache, an `ETag` and a `Range` resume all require to be stable — so client acceptance is not evidence of stability.**

What this still does not prove

- ~~**arm64 has never been executed.**~~ **Closed 2026-09-06.** Both the cross-compiled arm64 binary and the published arm64 container image ran on a Raspberry Pi 4 Model B Rev 1.5 (`aarch64` , Debian 13 trixie), each indexing the 22-song corpus in about 25 ms, and the archives they served were byte-for-byte identical to every x86-64 sync. See `docs/TEST-CORPUS.md` , "The ARM leg". Note the caveats there: it was a Pi 4 rather than the 3B+ (that board is dead), the machine was one-shot and wiped, and the image was transported by `docker save` / `load` rather than pulled directly on the Pi.

- ~~**The Phase 2b exit criterion needs two clients.**~~ **Closed 2026-09-06.** YARG was installed on r7-desktop and both machines were scanned: 20 accepted, 2 refused on each, the same two songs. Doing it is what found the determinism defect above — see `docs/TEST-CORPUS.md`, fourth oracle run.
- ~~**One library, 22 songs, 224 KB.**~~ **Partly closed 2026-09-06.** Index time is linear at 0.57-0.59 ms/song and memory fits `13 MB + 6.5 KB/song`, measured at 1,000 / 10,000 / 31,109 songs; packing streams, with resident memory flat at 16.5 MB while serving 1.17 GB, and the cache bound held at 11x oversubscription. See `docs/SCALE.md`. **Still open:** every song in that experiment is synthetic, so a real library's *variety* is untested, and the oracle has never run at scale - which is the measurement most likely to find a rejection category we do not flag.

Re-deployed 2026-09-06 on `c623dae`, and what it proved beyond the fix

Every number above was taken from a server that packed with a random mask (`6bcf4ec` was running; an earlier revision of this document said `827e0fe`, which was the deployment before it). Pipeline 2259 published `c623dae` and the host was re-pulled:

```
docker pull registry.badassium.com/fatalexception/yarg-song-server:latest
docker rm -f yarg-song-server
rm -rf /mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/data/packs   # start with an empty cache on purpose
docker run -d ...                                       # identical arguments to the first deploy
```

The stored registry credential from 2026-09-05 was still valid, so no fresh login was needed. Wiping the pack cache first is deliberate: every archive is then packed by the new binary, and nothing served afterwards is a leftover of the random-mask era.

```
library indexed songs=22 distinct_charts=22 duplicate_packages=0 problems=0 took=11ms
pack cache bounded max_bytes=2147483648
listening addr=:8080 songs=/songs data=/data version=c623dae
```

Then five independent syncs were compared file by file:

Client	Server	Result
ENG-1	ENG-1, built from the working tree (windows/amd64)	reference
ENG-1	same, after wiping the whole pack cache	identical
r7-desktop	ENG-1's server	identical
ENG-1	**the vault2 container (linux/amd64)**	**identical**
r7-desktop	**the vault2 container (linux/amd64)**	**identical**

110 archives, two client machines, two servers built for different operating systems and by different toolchains, and one deliberate cache wipe — all one set of bytes. **The derivation is not platform-dependent**, which the fix needed to be but which nothing had shown until this run. Unmodified YARG on the container's output: **20 accepted, 2 refused**, the same two songs.

Worth stating plainly because it is the standard this project holds: the last row of that table is an identity established by hashing every file, not by arguing that identical inputs must give identical results.

Re-deployed 2026-09-06 on `423902b`, with archive ingest

The library on the host was replaced with the 23-case corpus, which includes `23-zipped.zip` — a song delivered as an archive rather than a folder — and the pack cache was wiped so nothing served afterwards was a leftover of the previous image.

```
library indexed songs=23 distinct_charts=23 duplicate_packages=0 problems=0 took=9ms
listening addr=:8080 songs=/songs data=/data version=423902b
```

Check	Result
`/version`	`423902b`
`/healthz`	200
The archive-sourced song in the catalog	`name="Zipped"`, `source_path="23-zipped.zip"`, **0 issues**
`yarg-sync` from an empty folder	23 downloaded, 0 failed, 238,215 bytes in 399 ms
Every archive vs the locally built server	**23 / 23 identical**

That last row is the container-independence property crossing a build platform: the song the **linux/amd64 container** ingested from inside a `.zip` is byte-identical to the one a **windows/amd64** build produced from the loose folder. Nothing about the container it arrived in, or the machine that packed it, reaches the bytes a client receives.

The host's stored registry credential was still valid, so no fresh login was needed.

Re-deployed 2026-09-06 on `077f36e`, and the hostile-archive fix measured on the real thing

Pipeline 2278 published `077f36e` (archive-ingest hardening). Two things were worth measuring here that a test cannot reach: whether a code change altered the bytes a client receives, and whether the new "this archive is unreadable" report actually arrives where an operator would see it.

`latest` **was confirmed to be the commit before it was run**, not assumed:

```
docker pull …:latest
docker pull …:077f36eb        # note EIGHT characters - CI tags with CI_COMMIT_SHORT_SHA
docker image inspect …:077f36eb --format '{{.Id}}'   # same image id as :latest
```

That the tag is eight hex characters and the git short sha is seven is a small trap: a `:077f36e` pull fails with `manifest unknown`, which reads like a missing image rather than a mistyped tag. `GET /api/v4/projects/53/registry/repositories/14/tags` lists what exists.

Nothing about a code change reached the bytes

The pack cache was hashed **before** the upgrade, wiped, and hashed again after the new binary had re-packed all 23 songs:

```
sha256sum *.sng | sort -k2 > /tmp/packs-423902b.txt   # before
# … pull, rm -f, rm -rf data/packs, docker run …
sha256sum *.sng | sort -k2 > /tmp/packs-077f36e.txt   # after
diff /tmp/packs-423902b.txt /tmp/packs-077f36e.txt    # no output
```

Check	Result
`/version`	`077f36e`
`/healthz`	200
Index	23 songs, 23 distinct charts, **0 problems**, 9 ms
23 archives re-packed on a wiped cache, vs the `423902b` cache	**byte-for-byte identical**
`yarg-sync` from ENG-1 over Tailscale	23 downloaded, 0 failed, 238,215 bytes in 312 ms
The 23 files the client received, hashed, vs the 23 packs on the server	**identical set**

The determinism property now holds **across a code change**, which is a different claim from the ones already recorded — those compared machines, operating systems and architectures at a fixed commit. Byte-stability across upgrades is what a client's `ETag` and `Range` resume actually depend on in practice, since a server gets upgraded far more often than it changes CPU.

The silently-ignored song, reproduced and then observed being reported

`077f36e` exists because a zip written with **backslash** separators used to disappear from a library with no message. A probe archive was built to be exactly that shape — `song.ini`, `notes.mid` and `song.ogg` under `Backslash Song\`, written with the separator stored verbatim — dropped into the host's library, and the server restarted.

Building the probe is itself instructive. Python's `zipfile` rewrites `os.sep` to `/` in `ZipInfo.__init__`, so `ZipInfo("Backslash Song\\song.ini")` silently produces a *forward* slash and the probe proves nothing; the name has to be assigned after construction. And `namelist()` normalises backslashes when reading back, so the file looks wrong even when it is right — the only honest check is to count `0x5C` bytes in the file itself. **Both the writer and the reader hide the thing being tested**, which is the same shape as the defect: a convenient view of an archive is not the archive.

```
level=INFO  msg="library indexed" songs=23 distinct_charts=23 duplicate_packages=0 problems=1
level=WARN  msg="could not index" path=24-backslash.zip
            err="scan: archive contains a song.ini or a chart but no song folder could be read
                 from it; if it was made by an old Windows tool it may use backslash path
                 separators - re-zipping it will fix that"
```

It appears in `/api/v1/library` under `problems` as well as in the log, so an operator with no shell on the host still sees it. Before this commit the same file produced `problems=0` and no mention anywhere.

The probe was removed afterwards and the library restored to the 23-case corpus — a permanent `problems=1` would make every future index report ambiguous. `0 problems`, `restarts=0`, health 200 at the end.

Re-deployed 2026-09-07 on `64b42af`, and the first test with real concurrent clients

`64b42af` is the build that stopped the server 404-ing songs that exist (see ADR-002, "Concurrency"). Deployed the same way: confirm the tag is the commit by image id, wipe the pack cache, recreate.

Take the eight-character tag from `git rev-parse`, do not type it from memory. The image tag is `CI_COMMIT_SHORT_SHA` — eight characters — and the git short sha is seven. Guessing the eighth produced `64b42af7` and a `manifest unknown`, which reads like a missing image rather than a typo. The sha is `64b42af1b368…`, so the tag is `64b42af1`, and its image id matched `:latest` exactly.

Check	Result
`/version`	`64b42af`
`/healthz`	200, `restarts=0`
Index	23 songs, 23 distinct charts, **0 problems**, 15 ms
23 archives re-packed on a wiped cache, vs the `077f36e` cache	**byte-for-byte identical**

That is determinism holding across a **second** code change, on top of the machines, operating systems and architectures already covered.

Four real clients at once, over the network

Every concurrency measurement until now used goroutines against an in-process test server. Four `yarg-sync` processes were run simultaneously from ENG-1 against the vault2 container over Tailscale:

Client	Result
1	23 downloaded, 0 failed, 238,215 bytes, 456 ms
2	23 downloaded, 0 failed, 238,215 bytes, 448 ms
3	23 downloaded, 0 failed, 238,215 bytes, 483 ms
4	23 downloaded, 0 failed, 238,215 bytes, 449 ms

Every file byte-identical across all four clients, compared by SHA-256 per filename rather than by count or total. Four simultaneous clients cost about 40 ms each against the ~410 ms a single client took earlier, so nothing here is serialising badly.

What this run does NOT test, stated because it would be easy to read it as more than it is: this deployment's cache bound is 2 GB against a 238 KB library, so **nothing is ever evicted** and the defect `64b42af` fixes could not fire here even on the old build. This exercises the concurrent *serve* path over a real network; the eviction race is covered by

`internal/httpapi/concurrency_test.go`, which has to bound the cache to a single archive to provoke it at all. A Pi with a small SD card and a large library is where the two conditions meet, and that combination is still unmeasured on real hardware.

Upgrade to `a5f98c4`, 2026-09-07 — the pack-cache race and the chart checks

Pipeline 2295. Two changes worth deploying: the eviction race in `packcache` that answered **500 for a song that exists** on Linux (see `docs/ADR-002-v1-store.md`), and the two new chart issues, `chart_unreadable` and `chart_truncated`.

`:latest` was confirmed to BE the commit before anything was recreated, by image id rather than by trust:

```
docker pull -q …:latest
docker pull -q …:a5f98c41     # EIGHT characters; CI tags with CI_COMMIT_SHORT_SHA
docker image inspect …:latest    --format '{{.Id}}'   # sha256:b2bc48bb…
docker image inspect …:a5f98c41  --format '{{.Id}}'   # sha256:b2bc48bb…  same
```

The container was pinned to `:a5f98c41` rather than `:latest`, so `/version` and the running image agree even after the next pipeline publishes.

Determinism held across a fourth code change

The pack cache was hashed before the upgrade, wiped, and every song re-fetched so the new binary re-packed all 23:

```
archives before: 23  after: 23
BYTES IDENTICAL across the code change
```

That is the fourth code change this has been checked across, and the check is cheap enough that there is no reason to stop doing it.

Check	Result
`/version`	`a5f98c4`
`/api/v1/library`	23 songs, 23 distinct charts, `problems: null`
Browse page `GET /`	200, 9,365 bytes
`GET /nope`	404 — the catch-all trap has not come back
Pack cache after re-fetch	23 archives, byte-identical to before

What this does NOT verify, and it is the important one: the defect this upgrade exists to fix cannot fire on this deployment. The bound here is 2 GB against a 225 KB library, so nothing is ever evicted, and the rename-then-open window only opens when eviction runs concurrently with packing. The fix is covered by `TestEvictionNeverStealsAnArchiveBeforeItsPackerCanOpenIt`, which has to bound the cache to a single archive to provoke it at all. **A green deployment here is not evidence about the race.** The place the two conditions actually meet is a Pi with a small card and a large library, and that is still unmeasured on real hardware.

Second deployment, 2026-09-08 — `a5f98c4` to `3f80da0`

The live server had drifted a day behind `main`, so it was missing the browse page's scan-health view among other things. Updated in place, verified rather than assumed.

The image tag is the EIGHT-character short sha, which is the thing most likely to trip somebody up: `3f80da0ad757…` publishes as `:3f80da0a`, not `:3f80da0`. A seven-character pull fails with `manifest unknown`, which reads like a missing image rather than a typo.

The old container's configuration was read, not recalled. `docker inspect` gave the exact `Cmd`, port bindings, restart policy and mounts, and the new container was created from those rather than from the example earlier in this document. An example in a doc is a record of what was run once, not a description of what is running now.

```
docker pull registry.badassium.com/fatalexception/yarg-song-server:3f80da0a
docker rename yarg-song-server yarg-song-server-prev && docker stop yarg-song-server-prev
docker run -d --name yarg-song-server --restart unless-stopped -p 8099:8080 \
  -v /mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/songs:/songs:ro \
  -v /mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/data:/data \
  registry.badassium.com/fatalexception/yarg-song-server:3f80da0a \
  --songs /songs --data /data --listen :8080
```

The previous container is renamed and stopped, not deleted. Rolling back is `docker rm yarg-song-server && docker rename yarg-song-server-prev yarg-song-server && docker start yarg-song-server`. Delete it once the new one has been trusted for a while.

Verified after the swap

Check	Result
`/version`	`3f80da0` — the image is the commit it claims to be
Startup log	`songs=23 distinct_charts=23 duplicate_packages=0 problems=0 took=19ms`
Browse page carries the health machinery	all four markers present
Browse page still self-contained	**0** external references
A real song downloads	`200`, 8,471 bytes, begins `SNGPKG`
`/nope`	`404` — the root is still an exact match, not a catch-all

The last two matter more than they look. A deployment that serves a page but not a song is a deployment that passes a health check and fails a player; and the `GET /{$}` versus `GET /` distinction is the kind of thing an image rebuild could quietly undo, turning every 404 into HTML that a sync client would try to parse as a `.sng`.

State check over Tailscale, 2026-09-08 13:52Z — read-only, nothing deployed

Reached vault2 as `vault2.tail20252e.ts.net` rather than `192.168.2.7`; the Tailscale name works off-LAN and the LAN literal does not.

Measured	Value
`docker inspect`	`running`, started `2026-09-08T02:39:26Z`, **restarts=0**
Image	`registry.badassium.com/fatalexception/yarg-song-server:3f80da0a`
Ports	`8080/tcp -> 0.0.0.0:8099`
`GET /healthz` on `:8099`	`200`
Startup log	`songs=23 distinct_charts=23 duplicate_packages=0 problems=0 took=19ms`
Commits behind `origin/main` (`3f80da0..7e12e55`)	**17**

The live deployment is healthy and has not restarted; it is simply old on purpose. Nothing here was changed — deploying, and turning `check_uploads` on, are both still Jay's calls.

The image is distroless, so `docker exec <name> sh -c ...` fails with `exec: "sh": executable file not found in $PATH`. That is the image behaving correctly, not a broken container. An authenticated `/api/v1/*` probe therefore cannot be run from inside the container; use `/healthz` (unauthenticated) plus the startup log, or call the API from a host that holds the key.

The registry's on-disk tag directory is NOT a reliable inventory

Listing `/var/opt/gitlab/gitlab-rails/shared/registry/docker/registry/v2/repositories/<ns>/<img>/_manifests/tags` inside the GitLab-CE container returned **69** tags and omitted `7e12e557` — the tag for `main`'s head, whose pipeline had succeeded 90 minutes earlier. The GitLab API returned **70**, including it. Read from the disk, the conclusion would have been "CI never published an image for HEAD", which is false and would have been the ninth wrong-instrument finding in this project.

Use the API, and take the digest, not the tag name:

```
GET /api/v4/projects/<id>/registry/repositories
GET /api/v4/projects/<id>/registry/repositories/<repo_id>/tags/<tag>   -> .digest
```

`latest` and `7e12e557` resolve to the same digest (`sha256:2597abd874b3b646…`), so `:latest` currently *is* head-of-`main` — but that is a measurement with a timestamp on it, not a property. Compare digests every time; a tag name is a label somebody can move.

Pipeline history for the 17 undeployed commits is 16 `success` and one `failed` (`e8eda83b`, a docs commit). Project id is **53**; the credential is Windows Credential Manager `dev:gitlab-ce-pat`, read via `CredRead` so the token never reaches a command line or the transcript.

Third deployment, 2026-09-08 — `3f80da0` to `027d331`, and v0.1.0

31 commits, covering the feature registry, the config menu and its persistence, `-trimpath`, and the release packaging. **Feature defaults are unchanged**, so this is a code update rather than a posture change: `browse_ui` on, `check_uploads` off, `config_writes` off.

The pull failed first, and the reason is a landmine this document has warned about in general terms. vault2's cached registry credential in `/root/.docker/config.json` had one auth entry and was refused (`denied: access forbidden`). `/root` does not survive a reboot on Unraid, so a cached docker login is not durable infrastructure — it is something that works until it doesn't, silently, at the moment somebody needs to deploy.

The 1Password item named `GitLab Registry Pull (vault2 deploy token)` is NOT for this project. Its username is `fallout-pull` and it is scoped to fallout-research: `docker login` succeeds with it and the very next `docker pull` is denied, which reads like a registry fault rather than a scope one. The generic name is the trap. What worked is the documented route — a GitLab PAT with `api` scope, `--password-stdin` so the token never reaches `argv`.

The login was removed again immediately after the pull (`docker logout`). An `api`-scoped token is far more than a pull needs, and leaving one cached on the box is a standing over-grant. The container runs from the local image afterwards and needs no registry access. **The right fix is a project-scoped `read_registry` deploy token for `fatalexception/yarg-song-server`, stored in 1Password under a name that says which project it belongs to** — that is a credential change and belongs to Jay.

```
docker pull registry.badassium.com/fatalexception/yarg-song-server:027d331f
docker rm -f yarg-song-server-prev            # the 16h-old rollback, now superseded
docker rename yarg-song-server yarg-song-server-prev && docker stop yarg-song-server-prev
docker run -d --name yarg-song-server --restart unless-stopped -p 8099:8080 \
  -v /mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/songs:/songs:ro \
  -v /mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/data:/data \
  registry.badassium.com/fatalexception/yarg-song-server:027d331f \
  --songs /songs --data /data --listen :8080
```

The container's configuration was **read from `docker inspect`, not recalled from this document** — an example here is a record of what was run once, not a description of what is running now.

Verified after the swap

Check	Result
`/version`	`027d331` — the image is the commit it claims to be
Startup log	`songs=23 distinct_charts=23 duplicate_packages=0 problems=0 took=19ms`
`/healthz`	200
`GET /`	200, 19,956 bytes (the page grew with the settings panel)
`GET /nope`	**404** — the root is still an exact match, not a catch-all
`POST /api/v1/check`	**404** — off, and still *absent* rather than forbidden

Check	Result
`PUT /api/v1/features/{name}`	**404** — writes off, so the route is not there
A real song	200, 8,471 bytes, begins `SNGPKG`

The last three matter most on this deployment. The routes for `check` and the feature writer are now **registered unconditionally** — that changed in this batch so features could be toggled at runtime — and the guarantee that a disabled feature is indistinguishable from an absent one is now kept by the handlers rather than by the router. Those two 404s are that guarantee, measured on the live server rather than only in a test.

`config_writes` is off here, so nobody can change this server's features over HTTP. Setting it to `local` would only help somebody with a shell on vault2 anyway; `lan` is the one that would matter, and on a box reachable from the whole house that is a decision rather than a convenience.

v0.1.0

Tagged at `027d331`. The `release:tag` job produced all six archives plus `SHA256SUMS` with **`artifacts_expire_at = NEVER`**, which is the whole point of tagging.

A tagged pipeline did NOT build a container image, and "skipped" understates it: `container-image` ran on the default branch and on `ci/*`, a tag has no `CI_COMMIT_BRANCH`, so the job was **absent from the pipeline entirely** — not listed with a reason. Pipeline 2383 is green with four check jobs and `release:tag` and nothing else. The image for this commit exists as `:027d331f` from the `main` pipeline, so nothing was missing that day, but `:v0.1.0` is not in the registry and never will be.

Fixed on 2026-09-08 by `- if: '$CI_COMMIT_TAG'`. It cannot be applied retroactively: a tag pipeline builds from the tag's own commit, and `v0.1.0` points at `027d331f`, which predates the rule. Re-running it reproduces the same imageless pipeline. **`v0.1.1` is the first release with an image.**

Fourth deployment, 2026-09-08 — `027d331` to `v0.1.1`, and the first release-pinned container

The first deployment that pins a **release** rather than a commit, and the first where `/version` answers with a version number instead of a sha.

Pinned by DIGEST, not by tag, and that is a change of practice with a reason measured the same day: the `:<short sha>` tag is NOT immutable. Commit `1ef7598e` was built twice — once by its `main` pipeline, once by the `v0.1.1` tag pipeline — and the second push moved `:1ef7598e` to the newer image, so `:main` and `:1ef7598e` now name one commit and resolve to different digests. A digest is the only reference that cannot move under a running deployment.

```
docker pull registry.badassium.com/fatalexception/yarg-song-server@sha256:a127c732b8b58614…
docker stop yarg-song-server && docker rename yarg-song-server yarg-song-server-prev
docker run -d --name yarg-song-server --restart unless-stopped -p 8099:8080 \
  -v /mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/songs:/songs:ro \
  -v /mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/data:/data \
  registry.badassium.com/fatalexception/yarg-song-server@sha256:a127c732b8b58614… \
  --songs /songs --data /data --listen :8080
```

Check	Before (`027d331f`)	After (`v0.1.1`)
Image id	`c45f8b9c…`	`f323f3b8…` , `arch=amd64`
`/version`	`027d331`	**`v0.1.1`**
`/healthz`	200	200
Index	23 songs, 23 charts, 0 problems	23 songs, 23 charts, 0 problems, **9 ms**
`restarts`	0	0
Features	`browse_ui` on, `check_uploads` off, `config_writes` off	unchanged

One song was fetched from the running release, not just counted: `dc079fac…` returned 200 and 8,471 bytes hashing to `e9948d1e85f9317b22fd95af9e3230224d8dc050adb0cc7570e2d774738022eb` — **byte-identical to the same song served by a local Linux build earlier that day**. Determinism now holds across the shipped release image as well as across machines and architectures.

The previous container is kept stopped as `yarg-song-server-prev` on `:027d331f`; rollback is `docker stop yarg-song-server && docker start yarg-song-server-prev` after a rename.

Registry auth is still an open gap. The pull was denied until a login, and the credential used was the `api` -scope GitLab PAT again. It was fed over SFTP to a `600` file, consumed by `--password-stdin` , shredded, and `docker logout` ran immediately — `/root/.docker/config.json` is 16 bytes afterwards, so **no registry credential is stored on vault2**. The durable fix is still a project-scoped `read_registry` deploy token, which nobody has created.

Current state, measured 2026-09-15

Read directly off the box rather than inherited from an earlier section of this document, because the two had drifted — everything above was written while the container was still on `027d331f` , and this file went on saying so.

```
yarg-song-server   Up 6 days   restarts=0   restart=unless-stopped
image   registry.badassium.com/fatalexception/yarg-song-server@sha256:a127c732…
        (= :v0.1.1 = :latest, pinned by DIGEST, not by a floating tag)
started 2026-09-08T21:20:06Z
ports   8099 -> 8080          /healthz = 200
mounts  /mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/songs -> /songs   ro
        /mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/data  -> /data    rw  (65532:65532)
args    --songs /songs --data /data --listen :8080
image size   10,183,116 bytes (9.7 MiB)
library      23 songs, 568 KB — still the mkcorpus TEST CORPUS, not a real library
```

So the "deploy vault2 to v0.1.1" item was already done on 2026-09-08 and had been sitting open in two places since. There is also a stopped `yarg-song-server-prev` on the old `027d331f`, kept deliberately as a rollback.

`/songs` **holds the 23-case synthetic corpus.** Pointing this at a real library is a mount change and a restart, not a migration — the server re-indexes on start and never writes to that directory.

The Unraid template (2026-09-15)

The container was an ORPHAN in Unraid's Docker tab for ten days. It was created with the hand-rolled `docker run` at the top of this document, and a container with no template gets no edit form, no update button and no autostart toggle — and a GUI "recreate" would not have known about the mounts at all. Nothing was broken; it simply could not be managed from the UI, and the only record of how to reproduce it was this file.

`deploy/unraid/my-yarg-song-server.xml` fixes that. It describes the container **exactly as it already runs**, so installing it changed nothing about the running service — verified after the install: `healthz=200`, still `Up 6 days`, `restarts=0`.

Installed and checked:

`xmllint --noout` on the template	VALID
the validator itself, against deliberate garbage	rejects it (so VALID means something)
`<Name>` matches the running container	`yarg-song-server`
`<DateInstalled>` vs `State.StartedAt`	both `2026-09-08T21:20:06Z`
Config `Target=` / `Mode=` vs the container's mounts	`/songs` ro, `/data` rw — match
Port Config vs `HostPort`	8099 — match
file mode vs the neighbouring templates	`600 root` — match
`docker update --restart unless-stopped`	set
`/var/lib/docker/unraid-autostart`	`yarg-song-server` added (72 entries → 73)

Autostart is two independent mechanisms and both are now set. The docker restart policy is what actually survives a reboot; the autostart file is what makes the WebUI toggle agree and sets start order. Setting only one gives a container that comes back but shows as disabled, or a toggle that lies.

The template uses `:latest`, not the digest the container currently runs. Deliberate: a digest cannot be updated from the UI, and `:latest` already means *the newest release* rather than the newest commit, which is the right thing for a button a person presses. The running container keeps its digest pin until something recreates it. For a deployment that must not move at all, put the digest back in the template's `<Repository>` and accept that the update button becomes decorative.

Two things the UI will do that look like faults

- **The Console button fails**: `exec: "sh": executable file not found in $PATH`. Measured, not assumed. The image is distroless — there is no shell in it. Use the WebUI, `/healthz`, or the container log.
- `:latest` **will look stale** whenever `main` has moved and no tag has been cut. That is the tag doing its job. Cut a release; never repoint `:latest` at a branch.

For anything that is not Unraid

`docker-compose.yml` at the repo root, and `deploy/README.md` for both paths. Compose works on Unraid too and is still the wrong answer there — a compose stack is an orphan in the Docker tab, which is the whole problem the template solves.

The YARG share, and a real library (2026-09-15)

Until now the container served `/mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/songs` — the 23-case synthetic corpus, 568 KB of scanner fixtures. Song content was living in `appdata`, which is where a *service* keeps its state, not where somebody's music belongs. It now has its own share.

```
share   YARG            /mnt/user/YARG
        songs/          the library the server serves, mounted READ-ONLY
        playlists/      reserved
        art/            reserved
```

Settings (`/boot/config/shares/YARG.cfg`, version-controlled at `deploy/unraid/YARG-share.cfg`):

`shareUseCache`	`yes` — writes land on the NVMe, the mover pushes to the array hourly
`shareCachePool`	`cache`
`shareAllocator`	`highwater`
`shareExport` / `shareSecurity`	`e` / `private`, write list `fatalexception`

Array, not cache-pinned, and that is deliberate. The house rule is that new *services* go on `/mnt/cache/...` — that exists because of SQLite-on-FUSE corruption and a full array, and neither applies to read-only song files. Charts are hand-made work; parity protection is worth more here than shfs overhead on a mount the server never writes to. The array had 2.8 TB free when this was decided (the "99% full / 567 GB" figure in older notes is from 2026-09-06 and is stale).

Creating a share by hand does NOT export it over SMB

The part worth keeping, because every visible signal said it had worked:

- Writing `/boot/config/shares/YARG.cfg` and `mkdir`ing `/mnt/user/YARG` is enough for **emhttpd** — the share appeared in `/usr/local/emhttp/state/shares.ini` with every setting correct.
- It is **not** enough for **samba**. `/etc/samba/smb-shares.conf` is generated by emhttpd, not by `rc.samba`, and it stayed at 25 stanzas with no `[YARG]`. The share existed, was configured, and was invisible to every Windows machine.

The supported trigger is the same command the SMB security form posts (`/usr/local/emhttp/plugins/dynamix/SecuritySMB.page`, `changeShareSecurity`):

```
emcmd
"changeShareSecurity=Apply&shareName=YARG&shareExport=e&shareSecurity=private&shareWriteList=fatalexception&shareR
eadList=&shareVolsizelimit="
```

Post the values that are **already in the cfg** and it is a no-op to the file and a trigger for the samba config. Measured: 25 → 26 stanzas, `[YARG]` present with `write list = fatalexception`, no other share's stanza disturbed, and `smbclient -L localhost` lists it — which is the far-end proof, not the file.

Two smaller traps met on the way:

- **Unraid quotes share names in `shares.ini`** (`["YARG"]`), so a grep for `^.YARG.$` finds nothing and reads as "emhttpd has not seen it". It had.
- **emhttpd rewrites share cfgs with CRLF.** A `diff` against an LF copy reports every line changed. `file` is what settles it; the content was identical.

128 real songs, copied over the LAN

`C:\dev\_incoming\YARG\library` on ENG-1 → `\\192.168.2.7\YARG\songs`:

```
Dirs : 129 copied    Files : 644 copied    Bytes : 1.162 g    FAILED : 0
42 seconds, ~28 MB/s
```

Over SMB, not through the device bridge — 1.2 GB against a ~50 s transfer budget is not viable, and both machines can already see each other. Originals on ENG-1 are untouched; this was a copy.

`extracted/` is not a duplicate of `library/`. Both hold 644 files and 1,190 MB, which is why it first looked like the same songs twice. It is the same 128 songs arranged as **3 pack folders** (`Alternative Pack Vol.2`, `Grateful Dead - Phish`, `METAL PACK`) rather than flat. Equal file counts and equal byte totals are not equal content; comparing the folder *names* is what said so. The flat layout was the one copied.

Result

```
container recreated on /mnt/user/YARG/songs:/songs:ro   (data mount unchanged)
image still pinned @sha256:a127c732…  (= v0.1.1)
healthz = 200        version=v0.1.1
library: songs=128  distinct_charts=128  duplicate_packages=0  problems=null
```

0 problems across 128 real charts — worth noting as a data point rather than a claim: it means the scanner accepted all of them, not that YARG would.

The synthetic corpus is **left in place** at `/mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/songs`. It is still what the oracle and the sync tests use, and it is 568 KB.

To add songs now: drop them in `\\vault2\YARG\songs` and restart the container. The server re-indexes on start and never writes to that directory.

Fifth deployment, 2026-10-30 — `v0.1.1` to `v0.1.2`, and the `;` fix

The first change to the server's Go code since `v0.1.1` (one of twelve commits; the rest are docs and deployment files). A song whose metadata held a `;` in a value — `charter = TheSheepQueen; Whizzer` — was in the catalogue and answered `GET /song/<hash>.sng` with **HTTP 500**, so a client syncing the library got 127 of 128 songs. The writer rejected `;` as "the format's own restriction"; the reference encoder (SngCli v0.3.0) packs it and decodes it back unchanged.

Superseded: the *Current state, measured 2026-09-15* block above. What runs now:

```
image    registry.badassium.com/fatalexception/yarg-song-
server@sha256:2d5ff48a089f965c68297cee9e278ca479d54965915b2e13aaf30abd7b59ba4a
         (= :v0.1.2 = :latest, pinned by DIGEST)         image id 92e54925…, 10,183,116 bytes, linux/amd64
/version v0.1.2      /healthz 200      restarts=0      policy unless-stopped      user nonroot
mounts   /mnt/user/YARG/songs -> /songs  ro      /mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/data -> /data  rw
args     --songs /songs --data /data --listen :8080          port 8099 -> 8080
index    songs=128 distinct_charts=128 duplicate_packages=0 problems=0     took 8.6 s at start
```

The previous container is kept stopped as `yarg-song-server-v0.1.1` (the `v0.1.1` digest, `a127c732…`). Rollback is `docker rename` the two and `docker start` the old one, about ten seconds. `yarg-song-server-prev` is something else: a container on `027d331f` that exited seven weeks ago, and not a rollback for anything current.

What was done, and how

A release tag first, because this deployment pins a release: `v0.1.2` on `8f8370b`, pipeline 3593, all six jobs green. The registry's `:v0.1.2` and `:latest` resolve to one digest; `:main` is a different digest for the same commit, which is the tag/branch split `Fourth deployment` measured.

The registry login, because vault2 keeps none. The token was read once from Windows Credential Manager and written over SFTP to a mode-600 file on `/dev/shm` (RAM, not disk), then fed to `docker login --password-stdin`, the file removed, the image pulled, and `docker logout` run from an `EXIT` trap. Checked afterwards, not assumed:

token at the source vs on vault2	51 chars, same sha256 prefix both ends — and no BOM (first bytes were not `efbbbf`)
token files left in `/dev/shm`	0
`/root/.docker/config.json`	16 bytes — no credential stored
pulled digest	equals the one the registry reported

The swap rolled back by itself if it had to. `stop`, `rename` to `-v0.1.1`, `run`, then a 30 s health loop that required `/healthz` 200 *and* `/version` containing `v0.1.2`; failing that it would `rm -f` the new container, rename the old one back and start it. It was healthy 10 s after the new container started, 8.6 s of which was the index of 128 songs. The time the old container took to stop was not measured, so ten seconds is a floor for the downtime, not the figure.

Verified against a baseline taken BEFORE the deploy

Every song was `HEAD`ed on the live `v0.1.1` first and the status, `ETag` and `Content-Length` saved. After the swap:

Check	Result
the 127 songs that already worked	**127 of 127 identical** — status, ETag and length
Roots Bloody Roots (`f5178d27…`)	**500 → 200**; ETag `cd5f41c5…` equals the catalogue's `package_hash`; 2,774,330 bytes
those bytes vs a build of the same commit made on Windows	**SHA-256 identical** (`a8ddaa13…`)
SngCli decode of the served archive	0 errors; `charter = TheSheepQueen; Whizzer` intact
`SHA1(notes.mid)` in the served archive	equals the catalogue's `chart_hash` — identity holds

The ETag is the package hash, so "127 ETags unchanged" means the change cannot have reached any package whose metadata has no `;` in a value, which is what the one-line diff said it would not.

Three instrument errors, kept because each read like a result

- `package_hash` **is not the SHA-256 of the file.** It was tried as a download check and failed even for a song that served fine. It is the ETag; the file bytes hash to something else.
- `@($null).Count` **is 1 in PowerShell**, so `problems=1` appeared for a library with `problems: null`. The raw field and the server's own startup log (`problems=0`) both said otherwise.
- **PowerShell variable names are case-insensitive** (already in `WORKSPACE.md`): a loop variable `$s` overwrote the path variable `$S`, and the baseline file silently failed to write — twice.

Still open

- **The game has not loaded the `;` package.** Everything above is the server and the reference encoder. The in-game check is a sync from a client that is one song short, then `server:` in the song list showing 128.
- **The container may not be Unraid-managed.** Its `net.unraid.docker.managed` label is empty, so the *Docker* tab may not track it or offer an update. The likely cause is that the `docker run` that recreated it for the YARG share on 2026-09-15 did not link it to the template — an inference: only the empty label was measured, and what the Docker tab actually shows was not looked at.
- **There is still no durable registry credential.** This deployment used the `api` -scope token again, carefully, rather than the project-scoped `read_registry` deploy token that would make it unnecessary.

v0.1.3-yargsong, 2026-10-31

The deploy that made YARN setlists visible. Index went **128 -> 609 songs**, all 481 added by `yarn-install` and indexed through the new `.yargsong` path.

Built on vault2, not pushed through the registry. Docker Desktop was not running on ENG-1, and the alternative - copying a binary into the running container - leaves a container whose image label is a lie. `git archive HEAD` to a tarball, extract on vault2, `docker build` with the repo's own Dockerfile. The build stage cross-compiles anyway, so nothing about this needed buildx or a second architecture.

This command predates the unpack feature, so it has neither the nested `/songs/unpacked` `rw` bind nor `--config`. It is the record of what was run on 2026-10-31, not a command to reuse — see *Run it today*.

```
docker run -d --name yarg-song-server --restart unless-stopped \
  -p 8099:8080 \
  -v /mnt/user/YARG/songs:/songs:ro \
  -v /mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/data:/data \
  yarg-song-server:v0.1.3-yargsong --songs /songs --data /data --listen :8080
```

Rollback is the previous image, still on the box: `registry.badassium.com/fatalexception/yarg-song-server@sha256:2d5ff48a089f...`

Verified from ENG-1 rather than from the container: a song that came from a `.yargsong` (`Thomas Arne - A-Hunting We Will Go` , playlist `Keys Packs`) is in the catalogue and `GET /song/<hash>.sng` returns 1,282,103 bytes beginning `SNGPKG` - the decoy magic does not reach a client.

The deploy took the service down for ~30 seconds, and it did not have to

The first attempt ran `docker stop` and then `docker rename`, under `set -e`. The rename failed because a `yarg-song-server-prev` from seven weeks ago still existed, so the script aborted with the service stopped and nothing started. **Stop last, or rename to a name that cannot already be taken.** The recovery used a timestamped name; the old containers are still there, which is why the collision happened at all.

Three archives in the library are reported as problems

`/api/v1/library` now carries a `problems` array naming them, which is the scanner doing its job rather than a fault:

File	Reported
`Green Day Rock Band.zip`	archive holds more than one song folder
`Rock Band 4.7z`	archive holds more than one song folder
`Rock Band 3.zip`	`zip: not a valid zip file`

The first two are the multi-song case the scanner refuses by design rather than publishing one song and dropping the rest. The third is a different thing entirely - that file is not a readable zip at all, which usually means a truncated or interrupted download.

Storage layout — where the data lives, and where it must not (2026-11-01)

This is large-file storage. The song data lives on the ARRAY with the cache enabled, and never inside the docker image. Everything the server reads or writes is a bind mount; nothing of consequence is in the container layer, and a container that stored songs in its own filesystem would lose them on every upgrade while quietly filling the docker image file.

Measured on 2026-11-01 rather than assumed:

What	Where	How it is configured
`/songs`	`/mnt/user/YARG/songs`, 25 G	`shareUseCache="yes"`, `shareCachePool="cache"`, `shareAllocator="highwater"`
`/songs/unpacked`	same share, nested `rw` mount	owner `65532:users`, mode 775
`/data`	`/mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/data`, 2.0 G	addressed as `/mnt/cache/...`, so it never leaves the cache
container layer	nothing	both are bind mounts

The library is therefore already right: writes land on the NVMe cache and the mover migrates them to the array.

`/data` is the exception, and it is deliberate rather than accidental - it is the conventional Unraid appdata placement, it avoids FUSE overhead on the pack cache's many small reads, and the mover never churns it. What it costs is that this data exists on ONE device. That is tolerable only because everything in it is regenerable: the index is rebuilt at startup and the pack cache is bounded by `pack_cache_max` and re-packs whatever it evicts. Nothing in `/data` is the only copy of anything. **If that ever stops being true, `/data` moves to the share.**

One number that did not fit, and the answer was not storage

Moving 8 GB of archives onto the share over SMB ran at **4.8 MB/s** (1,012 MB in 212 s). A share with `shareUseCache="yes"` should be absorbing writes onto NVMe at far more than that on a gigabit link, and the cache was 55% full with 1.3 T free, so it was not spilling to the array for want of room.

It was recorded unexplained, with a note to measure the write path before touching the layout, because the temptation was to conclude "the array is slow" and move the library onto the cache - a large, hard-to-reverse decision from one measurement with no diagnosis. That caution was right. Measured the same day, in this order:

Measurement	Result	Rules out
`dd` to `/mnt/user/YARG` (through shfs)	647 MB/s	the array, the share, FUSE
`dd` to `/mnt/cache`	873 MB/s	the cache pool
vault2 `eth0`	1000 Mb/s full duplex	the server's link
robocopy `/J` vs `Copy-Item`, same file, same contention	1.3 vs 1.4 MB/s	**the copy tool**

The fourth line is the one worth keeping. Buffered copying over SMB is a known bottleneck and robocopy with unbuffered I/O is the usual remedy, so that was the hypothesis - and it was wrong, measured at 1.0x. The comparison was set up as a RATIO under identical load precisely so that it could come back negative, which it did.

What was left was the client:

```
ENG-2   192.168.2.46/23 on Wi-Fi        Ethernet: Disconnected
        SSID SchillingHaus-Legacy, channel 1 (2.4 GHz), 802.11ax
        transmit rate 135 Mbps, signal 66%
ping    min 17 ms  avg 33.8 ms  max 58 ms   -- to the same subnet
```

A Wi-Fi 6E adapter parked on 2.4 GHz channel 1, with LAN round trips an order of magnitude worse than a LAN should be. 135 Mb/s is about 17 MB/s before protocol overhead, and SMB is chatty enough that 34 ms round trips account for the rest.

So the storage layout was never implicated. Nothing about the array, the cache or the docker mounts needed changing, and changing them would have made the transfer no faster while making the deployment worse. The number came from the machine doing the copying, which was not part of the system under test at all - the fourth time on this project that the instrument was the fault.

Sixth deployment, 2026-11-01 — `0c6fa84`, the bare-CR fix, and an eleven-minute outage

The first deploy from a **registry image built by CI** since v0.1.2 — everything between was built on the box. It carries two code changes, because `0c6fa84`'s parent is `59f4449`: the bare-CR `song.ini` fix and `.rar` ingest. One image, one restart, both.

Superseded: *Current state, measured 2026-09-15* and the `v0.1.3-yargsong` block. What runs now:

```
image    registry.badassium.com/fatalexception/yarg-song-
server@sha256:9fa96f075aebe3e4278741fb18c8631c374fc6188a12fb9479d8534cf20a708a
         (= :0c6fa842, pinned by DIGEST)        CI pipeline 3672, all six jobs green
/version 0c6fa84      /healthz 200      restart unless-stopped      user nonroot
mounts   /mnt/user/YARG/songs            -> /songs           ro
         /mnt/user/YARG/songs/unpacked   -> /songs/unpacked   rw   (nested)
         /mnt/cache/appdata/yarg-song-server/data -> /data    rw
args     --songs /songs --data /data --listen :8080 --config /data/yarg-song-server.conf
port     8099 -> 8080
index    songs=3067 distinct_charts=3067 duplicate_packages=0 problems=0   took 10m40s
```

Rollback, kept stopped as `yarg-song-server-prev-20261101-212128` (v0.1.8-unpack):

```
docker rm -f yarg-song-server \
  && docker rename yarg-song-server-prev-20261101-212128 yarg-song-server \
  && docker start yarg-song-server
```

The library went 1,369 -> 3,067 in the same restart

1,698 songs arrived from Rock Band 2 and Rock Band 3 DLC, unpacked into `/songs/unpacked` immediately before the swap. That makes this deploy the first time this server has indexed **bulk third-party DLC**, which is the interesting part of it.

Verified against a baseline taken BEFORE the swap

The whole 1,369-song catalogue was snapshotted first — `package_hash` per `chart_hash` — and held as a **hard invariant rather than a tolerance**. The hash is over source file bytes while the fix only changes how metadata is *parsed*, so nothing may move; one that moved would be a finding about the fix.

Check	Result
baseline songs absent afterwards	**0**
baseline `package_hash` values moved	**0 of 1,369**
`problems`	**null** — no song failed to pack
issue codes across all 3,067 songs	exactly one, the pre-existing `chart_truncated`
values with a bare CR / LF / reserved key char	**0 / 0 / 0**
songs flagged `metadata_unreachable`	**0**
12 newly indexed songs fetched spread across the list	**12 of 12** real `SNGPKG`, 19–56 MB, `ETag` == `package_hash`

The zero got its instrument checked before it was believed, because a zero over 1,698 new songs is worthless if those songs carry no metadata: all 1,698 carry `raw_metadata`, **51,608 key/value pairs over 37 distinct keys**. And indexing is not packing — the defect being fixed was an HTTP 500 from `GET /song/<hash>.sng` — so archives were actually fetched rather than inferred from the catalogue.

The fix is deployed and has not yet fired, which is the honest result

The control-character count stayed at zero. It was 0 of 1,369 before and it is 0 of 3,067 now, across 1,698 freshly unpacked third-party songs where a malformed `song.ini` was the expected find. The only known instance anywhere remains the one song in `Marathon Hero 2.rar`, which is not in this library.

So the bare-CR fix is verified **harmless** here and not yet verified *useful* here. Its usefulness rests on the oracle run in `TEST-CORPUS.md`, where the real song packs and the real game accepts it — not on this deployment.

The real-library witness, and the prediction written down BEFORE the measurement

Later the same evening, `Marathon Hero 2.rar` — the archive the defect was found in — was unpacked into the live library. **The input is now on disk and the claim below is about the input only.**

Established, measured 2026-11-01 on vault2:

```
/mnt/user/YARG/songs/unpacked/Marathon Hero 2/Marathon Hero 2/Marathon Hero 2/
  29 - Take this Crusty L/
  04 Infant Annihilator - Behold the Kingdom of the Wretched Undying/song.ini

  preview_end_time = 905540\r
  song_length = 1062206\rplaylist_track = 4      <- bare CR, no trailing newline
```

1 of 152 `song.ini` files in that pack carries a bare CR, and the unpack did not normalise it — the file is CRLF throughout with one bare CR splicing the last two pairs. `internal/songini/testdata/bare-cr.song.ini` matches that shape byte for byte: 200 bytes, 8 CR against 7 LF, same tail, and `-text` in the index so no platform may rewrite it. The regression fixture is the real input rather than a reconstruction of it.

Not established: that the fix has fired. `/api/v1/library` still reports `built_at 2026-11-01T21:21:31.894Z` at 3,067 songs — the start-up index, which predates the unpack. On-disk input plus a correct reader *predicts* a behaviour; it does not measure one. Same shape as the oracle rule: a green from reasoning about someone else's input is not a measurement.

So the prediction goes here, before the index that will judge it:

After the next index, expect	Why
the song present, and `GET /song/<hash>.sng` → `200` with `SNGPKG` and `ETag == package_hash`	it 500'd before `0c6fa84`
`raw_metadata["song_length"] == "1062206"`	the value is cut at the CR, not discarded
`playlist_track` **absent** for that song	YARG loses it too; we lose what the game loses
exactly **1** song flagged `metadata_unreachable`, naming `playlist_track = 4`	it is a note, never a refusal
`problems` still `null`	the song is servable, so nothing failed to pack

And the instrument that will NOT show this, which is the trap. The control-character count over `raw_metadata` is expected to stay at **0**, because the fix *removes* the CR before the value is ever published. A zero there after the restart is the fix working, not the fix missing — so that count must not be read as the witness. The witness is the `metadata_unreachable` issue code, plus `song_length` intact while `playlist_track` is gone. Reading the old count and concluding "still nothing" would have been a wrong negative drawn from the right number.

What would falsify rather than confirm:

- **song absent entirely** → check the unpack completed before blaming the reader. That pack failed twice earlier the same evening for an unrelated reason: `.rar` directory entries carry a flag rather than a trailing slash, so every song folder read as a zero-byte file. Fixed in `fab8c90`. A missing song is a `.rar` question first and a CR question second.
- **song present but `GET /song/<hash>.sng` returns 500** → the fix does not work on real input, whatever the corpus said.
- **song present with no `metadata_unreachable`** → the reader reached the value by some path other than the designed one, and the issue plumbing in `internal/scan` is not wired to what `songini` dropped.

RESULT — all four predictions hit, 2026-11-02, and the fix is now verified USEFUL

The library was re-indexed at `00:20:22Z` and came back with 4,085 songs. Read off the live server directly rather than from another session's transcription of it:

```
issues      [{"code":"metadata_unreachable",
              "detail":"1 piece(s) of song.ini text are unreachable to YARG and
                        were dropped: playlist_track = 4"}]
            -- and exactly ONE song in 4,085 carries that code
raw_metadata song_length = "1062206"      intact
             playlist_track               ABSENT
GET /song/b67974e38009f0c20180ab46351274885888d894.sng
            -> 200, 38,972,988 bytes, magic SNGPKG, ETag == package_hash
date_added  2026-11-02T00:26:26Z          indexed in this run
problems    null                          as predicted; it never carries issue codes
```

So the caveat recorded above is now discharged. The bare-CR fix was *verified harmless* on this library and explicitly **not** verified useful; the endpoint that returned HTTP 500 for this song now returns a 38 MB archive with a matching strong `ETag`, and the only field lost is the one YARG loses too. The fix has a real-library witness, not just a corpus case — and the prediction was written down in `73b3179` **before** the index that produced it, so the match is a measurement rather than a reading.

Note the `source_path`: `unpacked/Marathon Hero 2/Marathon Hero 2/Marathon Hero 2/…` — triple-nested. That is the doubled-nesting unpack issue, not a CR issue, and it is cosmetic here.

A fifth near-miss, and the raw dump saved it again

A convenience grep for "is `playlist_track` present?" printed `"playlist_track":16000`, which reads as a flat contradiction of the prediction. It is not. That is the **top-level catalog field**, carrying the default for a key that was never set; the prediction is about `raw_metadata`, where the key is genuinely absent. Two fields, one name, opposite answers.

Reported as a grep line it would have been a *false falsification of a correct prediction*. What saved it was capturing the whole payload and judging it afterwards instead of pre-selecting fields — the fifth instance of one error in one night, and the fifth time the raw dump was the thing that caught it. See *Five instrument failures in one night* in `TEST-CORPUS.md`.

The service was hard down for 10m47s, and that is the real cost

21:21:31Z to 21:32:18Z. `/healthz` was **connection-refused** for the whole window, not 503: the listener does not come up until the index finishes.

The v0.1.3 deploy's ~30 seconds was a 23-song library. **Downtime on this architecture scales with library count**, and at 3,067 songs it is eleven minutes. At the next doubling it is twenty-odd. Neither this fix nor the DLC ingest caused that; the start-up reindex did, and it is worth solving before the library grows again. Nothing in this deploy's design would have helped — the rollback was armed and the health patience was 1800s precisely *because* a long index cannot be distinguished from a hang from the outside.

What the pre-flight caught, and why it was not optional

Every argument above was read off `docker inspect` of the running container. Following this document instead would have produced three wrong arguments, two of which fail silently — see *Run it today*, which exists because of this deploy.

Two more, both of which would have turned a working deploy into an incident:

- `internal/config` **treats an unrecognised key as a startup ERROR.** The live config was written for `v0.1.5-unpack`; a key added after `0c6fa84` would have stopped the new binary booting at all. Checked by *booting* `0c6fa84` against a copy of the live key set, not by reading the valid-key list.
- **The version string was predicted wrongly and the health check survived it.** See the tag-drift section. `git describe` on a workstation and in CI disagree for the same commit, because CI's clone has no tags.

Ninth deployment, 2026-11-02 — `01e0503`, the song.ini parser, and a dress rehearsal that matched byte for byte

```
version        01e0503    digest sha256:2fffb37d22f9aca1fd9e5ac99ac8f186db26ca5f516c2c810d72bdef091c933b
hard-down      0s         first answer was 503 "indexing"
healthy after  442s       index took=7m21.3s
songs 4085     distinct 4080     duplicate_packages 0     problems null
```

The check that mattered was not "is it up". A throwaway probe had already indexed the same library with the same image on a spare port, and its catalogue was kept. The deploy's pre-registered pass condition was that the live catalogue match that snapshot **byte for byte**, with any difference triggering an immediate rollback to `6cbea444`:

```
live sha       1fe46da2f6bb8799
expected sha   1fe46da2f6bb8799
IDENTICAL - production matches the probe exactly, field for field
```

That is a stronger claim than a song count. It pins every field of every one of 4,085 songs, including the 16 that this change deliberately altered, and it was decided before the deploy ran rather than inspected afterwards.

The rehearsal earned its place twice

Its **first** attempt died in 0.34 seconds: `packcache: mkdir /data/packs: permission denied`, because the probe's data directory was created root-owned and the image is distroless and runs as **nonroot uid 65532**. The same mistake in a real deploy is an outage. A locally cross-compiled binary run as root cannot reproduce it — which is exactly why ADR-008 now says to probe the image rather than a local build.

The worse half was the harness: the wait loop asked only "*does* `/healthz` *answer*", which cannot distinguish **still indexing** from **died instantly**, and it polled a stopped container for **39 minutes**. Both this deploy and the parity runner now check container liveness FIRST on every iteration and abort with the container's logs. A readiness check that cannot tell not-ready from dead is not a readiness check.

Probe timing is not a prediction, in either direction

	probe	production	
`6cbea44`	578s predicted	639s actual	probe **9.4% optimistic**
`01e0503`	742s	**441s**	probe **68% pessimistic**

Two runs, same box, same library, errors in opposite directions. The second is most likely page cache — production indexed about an hour after the probe had read the whole library — but that is a plausible mechanism and not a measurement, and it is recorded as such. The practical rule stands and is now better supported: **quote a probe figure as an estimate with its direction unknown.** What the probe reliably delivers is the catalogue to compare against, which is what this deploy actually relied on.
